

Marketing booklet of materials

100-200 level (Introductory/Intermediate)

MAM1010: MARKETING & MANAGEMENT

MAM1020: QUALITY CUSTOMER SERVICE

MAM1910: MAM PROJECT A

MAM2010: MANAGING FOR QUALITY

MAM2030: VISUAL MERCHANDISING

MAM2040: RETAIL OPERATIONS

MAM2090: PROMOTION – PRINT ADVERTISING

MAM2910: MAM PROJECT B

MAM2920: MAM PROJECT C

Course Description

The Marketing and Management course is designed to equip students with the foundational skills and knowledge necessary to excel in the dynamic fields of marketing and management. This comprehensive course offers a blend of theoretical insights and practical applications, enabling students to explore the core aspects of marketing strategies, consumer behavior, market research, digital marketing, and the management principles that underpin successful business operations.

This integrated course brings together six complementary CTS Marketing and Management (MAM) modules to provide students with a comprehensive understanding of modern retail, marketing, and service-based business operations. Students explore how organizations attract customers, deliver quality service, manage operations, ensure continuous improvement, and promote products effectively through visual and print advertising strategies. Emphasis is placed on practical application, employability skills, and real-world scenarios aligned with Canadian and Alberta business contexts.

Course Objectives

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

- Demonstrate foundational knowledge of marketing principles and management practices.
- Apply quality customer service standards in retail and service environments.
- Analyze and implement quality management systems to improve organizational performance.
- Design and evaluate effective visual merchandising presentations.
- Manage core retail operations, including pricing, inventory, and financial documentation.
- Plan, design, and assess print advertising campaigns for defined target markets.
- Evaluate the relationship between marketing, operations, service quality, and promotion in achieving business objectives.
- Develop transferable workplace skills including communication, problem-solving, ethical decision-making, and professionalism.



Units of Study

Foundations of Marketing and Management

- Role and functions of marketing in business
- The marketing mix (product, price, place, promotion)
- Management roles and responsibilities
- Consumer behavior and market segmentation
- Technology and trends influencing modern retail and marketing

Quality Customer Service Excellence

- Principles of quality customer service
- Professional interactions with customers, coworkers, and supervisors
- Handling complaints, returns, and challenging customer situations
- Sales clerk versus salesperson roles
- Building customer loyalty and trust

Managing for Quality and Continuous Improvement

- Common Quality Management Systems (QMS)
- Managerial roles in maintaining quality standards
- Use of data and technology to monitor performance
- Conflict resolution and ethical considerations in management
- Evaluating management strategies for quality improvement

Visual Merchandising and Design Principles

- Types of visual merchandising presentations
- Elements and principles of design
- Coordinating interior and exterior displays
- Seasonal, event-based, and promotional themes
- Planning, implementing, and evaluating visual presentations

Retail Operations and Financial Practices

- Pricing strategies, markup, and markdowns
- Break-even analysis and return on investment
- Inventory control and stock turnover
- Invoicing, receiving, and storage of goods
- Policies affecting retail operations and profitability

Promotion and Print Advertising Strategies

- Advertising objectives and target markets
- Components of effective print advertisements
- Media selection: print and broadcast advantages and limitations
- Geographical and promotional strategies
- Planning, costing, and evaluating print advertising campaigns

Instructions

This material has been created to enable you to engage in self-study of Marketing. Please follow the steps as identified in this booklet and address any questions to your instructor. Next Step



CTS: Marketing 10-20 (9 credits)

students are required to check in with their instructor(s) weekly. It is recommended that multiple check-ins occur each week to ensure successful completion of academic coursework. Students not adhering to the weekly check-in schedule or failing to engage in the learning process will be removed from their course.

Instructor

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Assessment

- **Formative Assessments:** Integrated into each unit; includes case analyses, scenario exercises, position papers, and research assignments.
- **Summative Assessment:** Comprehensive legal project incorporating elements from all six modules, demonstrating critical understanding and applied skills. Flexible submission options totaling 100 marks.

Students will be assessed through a combination of assignments, research activities, project work, presentations, observations, and focused conversations. Module work may be modified at the discretion of the instructor and after conversation with the student.

Each module is valued and graded out of 100 total marks, based on the key learner outcomes. Additionally, each module is weighted at 100% in the category weights as assignments category. Select elements of module work may be presented orally as approved by the instructor.

Our Next Step vision is to create a community of learners who embody the virtues of acceptance, flexibility, individualization, respect, and responsibility.

MAM1010: MARKETING & MANAGEMENT

Description: Students identify basic management and marketing concepts and describe retail merchandising strategies of value to the retail employee, manager or owner.

Marketing and Management explores how organizations operate, make decisions, and connect products and services with consumers. Students examine management roles, business ownership structures, retailing in Canada, and how marketing strategies influence consumer behavior, profitability, and society. Emphasis is placed on real-world examples to build practical financial, entrepreneurial, and workplace readiness skills.

Roles of Management: Refers to coordinating people and resources to achieve organizational goals efficiently and effectively. Key management roles include:

Planning

- Setting goals and determining actions to achieve them
- Example: A retailer planning seasonal inventory

Organizing

- Structuring tasks, roles, and resources
- Example: Assigning staff to departments

Leading

- Motivating, directing, and supporting employees
- Example: Store manager coaching new employees

Monitoring (Controlling)

- Tracking performance and correcting problems
- Example: Reviewing sales data and adjusting pricing

Communicating

- Sharing information clearly with employees, suppliers, and customers
- Example: Staff meetings, emails, advertising messages

Role of Retailing. Retailing is the process of selling goods and services directly to consumers for personal or household use. Retailers act as the link between manufacturers, wholesalers, and the end consumer. The role of retailing includes:

1. Providing Access to Products and Services

- Retailers make a wide variety of products available in convenient locations.
- Example: Grocery stores, clothing stores, online marketplaces.

2. Creating Value for Consumers

- Retailers package, display, and market products to make shopping easier and more appealing.
- Offer services like delivery, customer service, loyalty programs.

3. Supporting the Economy

- Retailing creates jobs (cashiers, managers, merchandisers).
- Generates tax revenue for governments.
- Stimulates production and innovation by creating demand.

4. Connecting with Society

- Retailers reflect cultural and social trends through products and marketing.

- Promote ethical and sustainable consumption choices.

Evolution of Retailing. Retailing in Canada has evolved from small local shops to complex, technology-driven omnichannel networks. Retailing is central to the economy, shapes consumer behavior, and continues to adapt to changing technology, culture, and society.

Early Retail (1800s–Early 1900s)

- General stores and small shops served local communities.
- Products were limited, and trade was often personal (barter or small cash transactions).

Department Stores & Chain Stores (1900s–1950s)

- Large stores sold a wide variety of products under one roof.
- Chain stores expanded across cities, offering standardized products and pricing.

Suburban Retail & Shopping Malls (1960s–1980s)

- Growth of suburbs led to shopping malls and big-box stores.
- Increased convenience and choice for consumers.
- Focus on customer experience and promotions.

Technology & Electronic Retailing (1990s–2000s)

- Introduction of electronic payment methods (credit/debit cards).
- Point-of-sale scanning and inventory management improved efficiency.
- Early e-commerce emerged.

Modern Retailing & Omnichannel (2010s–Present)

- Online retail, mobile apps, and home delivery dominate.
- Integration of physical and digital shopping experiences (omnichannel retailing).
- Personalized marketing and loyalty programs.
- Focus on sustainability, cultural awareness, and ethical practices.

Functions of Buying, Selling, and Merchandising. Retail businesses operate through three main functions that work together to meet customer needs, maximize sales, and ensure profitability: buying, selling, and merchandising.

Buying is the process of selecting, purchasing, and managing products that a business will sell to consumers.

- Products: Choosing items that meet consumer demand, trends, and quality standards.
- Supplier: Working with suppliers to get favorable prices, delivery schedules, and terms.
- Inventory: Maintaining appropriate stock levels to meet demand without overstocking.
- Forecasting Trends: Predicting which products will sell well in upcoming seasons.
- Example: A clothing store buyer decides to stock winter coats in October based on weather predictions, sales trends, and supplier availability.

Selling is the process of interacting with customers to complete transactions and provide service.

- Customer Assistance: Helping shoppers find the right product and answering questions.

- Transactions: Completing sales through cash, card, or online payments.
- Relationship Building: Creating loyalty by providing a positive shopping experience.
- Products: Highlighting features, benefits, and special offers to encourage purchases.
- Example: A salesperson explains the features of a laptop to a customer, answers questions, and completes the purchase.

Merchandising is the planning, presentation, and promotion of products in a way that encourages customers to buy.

- Display: Arranging items to attract attention (e.g., window displays, shelf placement).
- Packaging: Using attractive, informative packaging to influence consumer choice.
- Pricing Strategies: Setting prices that appeal to customers while ensuring profitability.
- Promotion: Using in-store advertising, demos, and loyalty programs to boost sales.
- Stock Control: Ensuring products are available and replenished in the right quantities.
- Example: A grocery store places eye-level shelves for popular cereals, uses bright packaging, and offers “buy one, get one free” promotions to increase sales.

Forms of Business Ownership

Type	Description	Advantages	Disadvantages
Sole Proprietorship	Owned by one person	Simple, full control	Unlimited liability
Partnership	Two or more owners	Shared resources	Shared liability
Corporation	Separate legal entity	Limited liability	Complex, costly
Franchise	Licensed brand model	Established brand	Fees, rules
Cooperative	Owned by members	Shared benefits	Shared decision-making
Conglomerate	Owens many companies	Diversification	Complex management
Multinational	Operates in many countries	Global reach	Cultural/legal challenges
Crown Corporation	Government-owned	Public service focus	Political oversight

Importance of Marketing. Marketing is essential to a market economy because it connects businesses with consumers by identifying and meeting their needs, which drives demand for goods and services. It encourages competition, prompting businesses to improve quality, lower prices, and innovate, which benefits consumers and stimulates economic growth.

Marketing also helps allocate resources efficiently by guiding businesses to invest in products and services that are in demand, while building customer relationships and loyalty through promotions, branding, and engagement. In this way, marketing acts as a key driver of economic activity, innovation, and consumer satisfaction in a market-based system.

Relationship Between Satisfying Consumers and Making a Profit. In a market economy, businesses exist to meet consumer needs while generating profit. These two goals are closely linked because satisfied customers are more likely to buy products, return for future purchases, and recommend business to others, all of which increase sales and revenue.

- **Customer Satisfaction Drives Sales:** When products or services meet or exceed consumer expectations, customers are more willing to spend money, leading to higher sales volumes.
- **Repeat Business and Loyalty:** Satisfied customers are loyal customers. Loyalty reduces marketing costs and ensures a steady income stream.
- **Positive Reputation and Referrals:** Happy consumers often share their experiences, attracting new customers without extra advertising costs.
- **Balancing Costs and Quality:** Businesses must provide value while managing costs. High-quality products and services may cost more but often allow higher pricing and stronger brand loyalty, increasing long-term profits.

Satisfying consumers is not separate from making a profit; it is a key strategy for achieving profitability. Businesses that prioritize consumer needs effectively build trust, loyalty, and revenue, creating a sustainable cycle of success.

The Marketing Mix. The marketing mix is a framework businesses use to make decisions that meet consumer needs, compete effectively, and achieve profitability. It consists of the Four P's (Product, Price, Promotion, Place) and the Two C's (Consumers, Competition)

The Four P's

1. **Product:** Refers to the goods or services a business offers to satisfy customer needs. Key considerations: quality, design, features, branding, packaging, and warranties.
 - *Example: A smartphone with high-quality camera, sleek design, and brand recognition.*
2. **Price:** The amount customers pay for a product or service. Strategies may include discount pricing, premium pricing, bundle pricing, or seasonal pricing.
 - *Example: A new video game might be priced higher at launch, then discounted later to attract more buyers.*
3. **Promotion:** How a business communicates with consumers to inform, persuade, or remind them about a product. Includes advertising, sales promotions, social media campaigns, sponsorships, and public relations.
 - *Example: A clothing brand using Instagram ads and in-store promotions for a new collection.*
4. **Place:** The location or channels through which products are sold to consumers. Includes physical stores, online platforms, distributors, or direct sales.
 - *Example: A bakery selling products both in-store and via online ordering system.*

The Two C's

1. **Consumers:** Focuses on understanding the target market: their preferences, habits, and needs. Helps businesses tailor products, prices, promotions, and distribution.
 - *Example: A company designing age-appropriate toys based on children's interests.*
2. **Competition:** Involves analyzing rival businesses to identify opportunities and threats. Helps set competitive prices, differentiate products, and design better marketing strategies.
 - *Example: A coffee shop offering specialty drinks to stand out from nearby chains.*

The marketing mix is a tool for making strategic decisions that balance consumer needs, competitive pressures, and business goals. By considering the Four P's and Two C's, businesses can create a strong, cohesive approach that attracts customers, increases sales, and builds long-term success.

Decision-Making. The marketing mix consists of the Four P's (Product, Price, Promotion, Place) and decisions in each area directly affect a business's success.

Product decisions focus on what the business will offer and how it meets customer needs:

- Design and Features: Choosing the look, size, quality, and functionality of a product.
- Branding and Packaging: Selecting a brand name, logo, and packaging that appeal to the target market.
- Product Variety: Deciding on product lines, models, or options.
- After-Sales Service: Offering warranties, customer support, or maintenance.

Pricing decisions determine how much customers pay and influence perceived value and sales:

- Pricing Strategy: Choosing between premium pricing, competitive pricing, discounts, or bundle offers.
- Payment Options: Allowing installment plans, credit, or loyalty program points.
- Profit Margin: Ensuring the price covers costs and generates profit.

Promotion decisions focus on how the business communicates with its target market:

- Advertising: Selecting media channels like TV, social media, or in-store ads.
- Sales Promotions: Offering limited-time discounts, contests, or free samples.
- Public Relations: Managing the business's image and reputation.
- Personal Selling: Training staff to explain products and persuade customers effectively.

Place decisions determine where and how customers access the product:

- Distribution: Choosing between direct sales, retail stores, online platforms, wholesalers.
- Location: Selecting store locations with high foot traffic or convenience.
- Inventory: Ensuring products are available when and where customers want them.

By carefully analyzing each component, businesses can satisfy consumer needs, compete effectively, and achieve profit. Every decision in the marketing mix is interconnected:

- **Product** decisions define what is sold,
- **Price** decisions influence how consumers perceive value,
- **Promotion** decisions determine how customers learn about the product, and
- **Place** decisions ensure the product is accessible.

Marketing Focus by Business Type. Marketing strategies vary depending on the role a business plays in the supply chain. Each type of business, manufacturers, wholesalers, and retailers, has a unique focus when marketing its products or services.

Manufacturers: Businesses that produce goods from raw materials or components. Focus:

- Focus on product and service development to meet consumer needs.

- Emphasize quality, features, and innovation to attract intermediaries (wholesalers and retailers) who will sell their products.
- Target market is often businesses (B2B) rather than end consumers.
- Example: A Canadian electronics manufacturer markets its high-resolution TVs to major retail chains rather than directly to households.

Wholesalers: Businesses that buy products in bulk from manufacturers and sell them to retailers or other businesses. Focus:

- Promote products and services to retailers rather than end consumers.
- Emphasize competitive pricing, reliable supply, and product variety.
- Relationship-building with retailers to ensure long-term contracts and consistent orders.
- Example: A beverage wholesaler markets soda and juice products to grocery stores and convenience stores across Alberta, highlighting volume discounts and timely delivery.

Retailers: Businesses that sell products directly to the end consumer for personal use. Focus:

- Focus on meeting consumer needs and preferences.
- Emphasize customer experience, convenience, promotions, and loyalty programs.
- Use merchandising, advertising, and pricing strategies to attract and retain consumers.
- Example: A clothing store markets seasonal collections to local shoppers through social media, in-store displays, and discounts.

The focus of marketing shifts along the supply chain: manufacturers market to businesses, wholesalers market to retailers, and retailers market directly to consumers. Each stage requires strategies suited to its target audience and role in delivering products.

Marketing Decisions on Society. Marketing decisions do more than influence consumer purchases, they impact society, culture, and the environment. Businesses must consider these effects to operate ethically and sustainably. Responsible marketing considers not only profit but also the long-term effects on society and the environment.

- **Environmental Impact:** Marketing decisions about packaging, product materials, and production methods can affect natural resources and waste. Example: Excessive plastic packaging contributes to pollution, while eco-friendly packaging reduces impact.
- **Cultural and Social Influence:** Advertising and product promotion shape social norms, trends, and consumer behavior. Example: Fashion or tech marketing may influence lifestyle choices or spending habits.
- **Ethical Considerations:** Misleading advertising, false claims, or targeting vulnerable populations can harm consumers and society. Example: Promoting unhealthy food to children can have long-term health effects.
- **Economic Effects:** Marketing drives demand, which affects job creation, economic growth, and resource allocation. Example: Successful marketing campaigns for a new product line can create manufacturing and retail jobs.
- **Community and Social Responsibility:** Businesses can use marketing to promote positive societal change, such as sustainability, diversity, or charitable initiatives. Example: Campaigns encouraging recycling or donating a portion of sales to community programs.

Marketing and retail merchandising are related but distinct business functions. Marketing is a broad, strategic process focused on understanding consumer needs, creating demand, and promoting products or services to target markets. It involves decisions about the product, price, promotion, place, consumers, and competition to achieve business goals and profitability.

Retail merchandising, on the other hand, is more tactical and focuses on the presentation and promotion of products within the store or sales environment to encourage purchases. This includes product placement, packaging, pricing strategies, displays, and in-store promotions. In essence, marketing sets the strategy to attract and satisfy customers, while retail merchandising executes these strategies at the point of sale to maximize sales and enhance the experience.

Role of Technology in Retail Evolution. Technology has dramatically transformed retailing in Canada and worldwide by improving efficiency, convenience, and customer experience. Retailers use technological innovations to streamline operations, enhance product quality, and meet consumer expectations.

- **Electronic Banking (Debit and Credit Cards):** Replaced cash as the primary payment method, making transactions faster, more secure, and convenient for consumers. Example: Shoppers can pay instantly using debit or credit cards, which also allows retailers to track sales data and customer spending patterns.
- **Home Shopping (Online Retailing):** Enabled consumers to browse and purchase products from home, expanding market reach beyond physical store locations. Example: E-commerce platforms like Amazon or Canadian online grocery services allow customers to shop 24/7 and have products delivered to their door.
- **Scanners and Universal Product Codes (UPCs):** Automated the checkout process, improved inventory management, and reduced errors in pricing. Example: UPC barcodes allow cashiers to scan items quickly, track stock levels, and reorder products efficiently.
- **Improved Product Quality:** Technology in manufacturing and production has raised product standards, consistency, and reliability. Example: Advanced machinery in electronics or food production ensures higher-quality goods, reducing defects and increasing customer satisfaction.
- **Just-in-Time (JIT) Delivery:** Optimizes inventory levels by delivering products only when needed, reducing storage costs and waste. Example: Retailers like grocery stores receive daily shipments of fresh produce based on predicted consumer demand, ensuring freshness and availability.

Technology has revolutionized retailing by enhancing convenience, efficiency, and quality. Electronic payments simplify transactions, online shopping expands market access, scanners and UPCs improve inventory management, production technology raises product standards, and just-in-time delivery reduces costs while meeting consumer needs. Together, these innovations allow retailers to respond faster, serve customers better, and compete in the modern marketplace.

Product Merchandising Strategies to Increase Sales. Product merchandising involves planning, presenting, and promoting products in ways that encourage consumers to buy. Retailers use several strategies to increase visibility, appeal, and sales.

- **Scrambled Merchandising:** Offering a wide variety of unrelated products in the same store to attract more customers. Example: A convenience store selling snacks, household items, electronics, and lottery tickets to meet different consumer needs in one trip.
- **Narrowing the Product Line:** Focusing on a smaller, specialized range of products to better meet customer preferences and reduce inventory complexity. Example: A boutique clothing store specializing only in women's formal wear, attracting a targeted customer base seeking specific products.
- **Sampling and Product Demonstrations:** Allowing customers to try products before purchasing or showing how products work. Example: A grocery store offering free samples of a new yogurt brand or a tech store demonstrating a new smartphone model.
- **Shelf Positioning (Eye-Level Placement):** Placing products at eye level to maximize visibility and encourage impulse purchases. Example: Popular cereal brands positioned at eye level in supermarkets to increase the likelihood of selection.
- **Packaging:** Designing attractive, informative packaging that draws attention and communicates the product's value. Example: Brightly colored snack packaging with clear labels and appealing images to entice consumers.
- **Brand Selection and Identification:** Highlighting well-known brands or creating strong brand identity to influence consumer choice. Example: A grocery store promoting Coca-Cola products with recognizable logos and branded displays.

Effective product merchandising strategies increase sales by making products more visible, attractive, and accessible to consumers. Retailers combine techniques such as scrambled merchandising, specialized product lines, sampling, strategic shelf placement, appealing packaging, and strong brand promotion to maximize customer interest and encourage purchases.

Pricing Merchandising Strategies to Increase Sales. Pricing merchandising strategies are used by retailers to influence consumer buying behavior, encourage purchases, and maximize profitability. These strategies help attract customers and create perceived value for products.

1. **Multiple Pricing:** Offering several items together at a single price, often lower than buying each individually. Example: "3 for \$10" deals on canned beverages or snacks encourage customers to buy more than they originally planned.
2. **Unit Pricing on Shelves:** Displaying the price per unit (e.g., per kilogram, per litre) to help consumers compare products and see value. Example: Supermarkets label cereal boxes with price per 100g so shoppers can easily compare brands.
3. **Warehouse Pricing:** Selling products in bulk at a lower price per unit to encourage large purchases. Example: Wholesale clubs like Costco offer large packs of paper towels or juice at a lower per-item cost than regular stores.
4. **Loss Leaders:** Pricing a popular product below cost to attract customers, hoping they will buy additional higher-margin items. Example: A grocery store sells milk at a very low price to bring customers in, knowing they will also purchase other full-priced items.

Pricing strategies are tools for influencing consumer behavior, increasing sales volume, and encouraging purchases. Techniques like multiple pricing, unit pricing, warehouse pricing, and loss leaders help retailers attract customers, provide value, and boost overall profitability.

Service Merchandising Strategies to Increase Sales. Service merchandising focuses on enhancing the customer experience and offering additional services to encourage purchases, build loyalty, and differentiate a business from competitors.

1. **Hours of Operation:** Extending store hours to provide convenience for customers. Example: A grocery store staying open late on weekends attracts shoppers who cannot visit during regular hours.
2. **Franchising (Consistency and Reliability):** Offering standardized products and services across multiple locations to build trust and brand loyalty. Example: Tim Hortons ensures that coffee, donuts, and service quality are consistent in every Canadian location.
3. **Loyalty Programs:** Rewarding repeat customers to encourage continued purchases. Example: A coffee shop offers a points system where every 10 coffees purchased earn a free drink.
4. **Delivery, Gift Wrapping, Installation, or Repair:** Providing additional services that make shopping easier or add value for the customer. Example: Furniture stores offering home delivery and assembly, or electronics stores providing installation services.
5. **Satisfaction Guaranteed:** Offering refunds, exchanges, or warranties to give customers confidence in their purchase. Example: A retailer allows customers to return clothing within 30 days with no questions asked, encouraging more purchases.

Service strategies increase sales by enhancing convenience, building trust, and creating positive customer experience. By providing extended hours, loyalty programs, additional services, and satisfaction guarantee, businesses attract more customers, encourage repeat business, and strengthen brand reputation.

Place Merchandising Strategies to Increase Sales. Place merchandising focuses on how and where products are made available to consumers. Effective placement strategies enhance convenience, visibility, and overall shopping experience, which can increase sales.

1. **Size of the Store:** Ensuring the store is appropriately sized to display products attractively and accommodate customer traffic. Example: Large supermarkets allow for wide aisles and ample displays, making shopping easier and encouraging purchases.
2. **Layout of the Store:** Strategically arranging products to guide customer flow, highlight key items, and encourage impulse buys. Example: Placing commonly purchased items, like milk or bread, around the store perimeter so shoppers pass other products.
3. **Use of Direct Lighting:** Using lighting to highlight products, attract attention, and enhance their appearance. Example: Jewelry stores use spotlights on display cases to make rings and watches sparkle and catch customers' eyes.

Merchandising strategies help businesses optimize the physical environment to improve product visibility, convenience, and customer experience. By focusing on store size, layout, and lighting, retailers encourage longer shopping visits, impulse purchases, and ultimately, higher sales.

Promotional Strategies to Increase Sales. Promotional merchandising focuses on attracting attention, informing customers, and encouraging purchases through various marketing tools and displays. Effective promotions can increase awareness, drive traffic, and boost sales.

1. **Visual Merchandising:** Using attractive displays and arrangements to showcase products and capture customer interest. Example: Window displays featuring seasonal products or themed layouts that draw shoppers into the store.
2. **In-Store Posters and Advertising:** Placing posters or signs around the store that coordinate with broader promotional campaigns. Example: A poster near the entrance advertising a summer sale that matches social media ads and flyers.
3. **Shelf Cards Indicating Specials:** Using small signs or tags on shelves to highlight discounts, new products, or special offers. Example: A shelf card showing “Buy One, Get One Free” on a popular snack encourages immediate purchase.
4. **Packaging and Labelling:** Designing packaging to attract attention, convey information, or reinforce promotions. Example: Brightly colored packaging with “Limited Edition” labels or promotional messages to entice buyers.

Promotional merchandising strategies increase product visibility, attract customer attention, and stimulate purchases. Techniques like visual displays, in-store posters, shelf cards, and eye-catching packaging help retailers communicate value, create excitement, and drive sales.

Required Assignment

/100 Marks

Flexible Submission Options: Students may choose one or a combination of the following: Written report, Slide presentation, Visual infographic, Video or recorded presentation, Digital portfolio, or Podcast.

Summative Assessment: Students will demonstrate their understanding of the following areas:

1. Describe the components of the ‘marketing mix’ (*four P’s: product, price, promotion, place, two C’s: consumers, competition*) and provide examples of each. (35 marks)
2. Explain the effect marketing decisions have on society. (10 marks)
3. Examine the role of technology in the evolution of retailing in Canada. (10 marks)
4. Analyze and show examples of placement merchandising strategies used to increase sales inside stores. (15 marks)
5. Describe and provide examples of promotional merchandising strategies used to increase sales. (30 marks)

Comments:

MAM1020: QUALITY CUSTOMER SERVICE

Description: Students identify and describe the target customer and the selling floor, including sales and nonsales activities. They will demonstrate techniques required by employees in the field. Quality customer service is a critical skill in every industry. Whether working in retail, hospitality, healthcare, trades, or business ownership, understanding customers and delivering consistent, respectful service is essential for success.

What Is a Target Market? A target market is a specific group of consumers that a business aims to sell its products or services to. Businesses focus on target markets to better meet customer needs and increase success.

Participants in a Target Market. A target market is not just a group of people, it is made up of specific participants who play different roles in the buying and usage process. Understanding each participant helps businesses tailor products, services, and marketing strategies effectively.

Buyers: Buyers are the people who actually make the purchase of a product or service. They control the money and the decision to buy. Their priorities often include price, quality, convenience, and perceived value. Buyers may not always be the end-users.

Example: A parent buying shoes for their child is the buyer, even though the child will wear the shoes. A company purchasing office supplies is the buyer, while employees are the users.

Users: Users are the people who use or consume the product or service. Users may or may not influence the purchase. Understanding user needs is essential for product design, functionality, and satisfaction. User experience drives repeat purchases and brand loyalty.

Example: In the shoes example, the child is the user. A student using educational software purchased by the school is the user.

Influencers: Influencers are individuals or groups who affect the buying decision, but may not purchase or use the product themselves. They can be family members, friends, colleagues, experts, or social media personalities. Influencers often provide opinions, recommendations, or reviews that shape buyer choices. Companies may target influencers with marketing campaigns to reach buyers effectively.

Example: A teenager recommending a gaming console to their parent acts as an influencer. Product reviewers or social media personalities influencing consumer choices are influencers.

Target Market Demographics: Demographics are the measurable characteristics of a population that businesses use to identify and segment their target market. They provide quantitative data that helps companies understand who their customers are. Understanding demographics allows businesses to tailor products, services, and marketing strategies to the people most likely to buy them.

Common Demographic Factors**1. Age**

- Groups such as children, teens, adults, and seniors
- Example: A toy company targets children aged 3–12

2. **Sex/Gender**
 - Male, female, or non-binary
 - Example: A cosmetics brand may primarily target women
3. **Income**
 - Household or individual income level
 - Example: Luxury car brands target high-income consumers
4. **Geographical Location**
 - City, province, region, urban vs. rural
 - Example: A surf shop targets coastal communities
5. **Education Level**
 - High school, college, university, vocational training
 - Example: An online learning platform may target college students
6. **Ethnic or Cultural Background**
 - Helps businesses understand cultural preferences and needs
 - Example: Food products marketed to specific cultural groups
7. **Economic Background / Occupation**
 - Types of jobs or industries people work in
 - Example: Professional clothing targeted at office workers

Target Market Psychographics: Psychographics are the attitudes, interests, lifestyles, values, and habits of people in a target market. While demographics tell us who the customer is, psychographics explain why they buy and how they behave. Understanding psychographics helps businesses create marketing strategies that connect emotionally with their audience.

Key Psychographic Factors

1. **Lifestyle:** The way people live, including daily routines, hobbies, and interests. Example: A fitness brand targets people who exercise regularly and value healthy living.
2. **Attitudes and Opinions:** How people feel about products, brands, or social issues. Example: Environmentally conscious consumers may prefer eco-friendly products.
3. **Interests:** Activities or topics people enjoy, such as sports, music, technology, or travel. Example: A travel agency targets consumers interested in adventure tourism.
4. **Values:** Core beliefs or priorities that guide decision-making. Example: Parents may value education and safety when choosing products for their children.
5. **Habits and Behaviours:** Buying habits, brand loyalty, media consumption, online activity. Example: Frequent online shoppers respond well to e-commerce promotions and social media ads.

Why Psychographics Matter

- Helps businesses understand motivations behind purchases
- Allows for personalized marketing and advertising
- Guides product design and features based on consumer preferences
- Builds brand loyalty by connecting with customers' values and lifestyles

Steps to Identify a Target Market

1. **Understand the Product or Service**
 - What problem does it solve?

- Who will benefit most from it?
- 2. **Analyze Market Participants**
 - Identify **buyers, users, and influencers**
- 3. **Segment by Demographics**
 - Age, gender, income, location, education, occupation, cultural background
- 4. **Segment by Psychographics**
 - Lifestyle, interests, values, habits, attitudes
- 5. **Research Consumer Needs and Behaviours**
 - Consider basic needs vs. wants, rational vs. emotional motives
- 6. **Refine and Focus**
 - Choose the group most likely to purchase repeatedly or advocate for the product

Every product or service has a unique target market. By combining demographics, psychographics, and consumer behaviour analysis, businesses can market effectively and provide quality customer service that meets their customers' needs.

Basic Needs. Basic needs are the essential items or services that people require to survive and maintain a healthy, safe life. These include necessities such as food, water, clothing, and shelter, which provide physical sustenance and protection from the environment. In addition, basic needs encompass healthcare, education, and safety, which ensure well-being and the ability to function effectively in daily life.

Consumers prioritize these needs before considering non-essential items, and businesses that provide products or services addressing these fundamental requirements often meet a constant and universal demand. Understanding basic needs helps businesses identify core customer requirements and design products that fulfill these necessities reliably.

Secondary Wants. Secondary wants are the non-essential goods and services that people desire to enhance comfort, enjoyment, or lifestyle rather than to satisfy basic survival needs. Unlike basic needs, secondary wants are influenced by personal preferences, social trends, and cultural factors. Examples include luxury clothing, smartphones, entertainment subscriptions, branded accessories, and recreational travel.

These wants are often driven by emotional or social motives, such as the desire for status, self-expression, convenience, or enjoyment. Understanding secondary wants helps businesses create products, marketing strategies, and services that appeal to consumers' aspirations and lifestyle choices beyond their essential needs.

Needs vs. Wants. Consumers make purchasing decisions based on *Necessity, Budget, Emotion, Social influence*, understanding the difference helps people manage money responsibly.

Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs. Maslow's hierarchy of needs is a psychological theory that explains human motivation through five levels, from basic survival to personal growth. In consumer behaviour, it helps businesses understand why people make certain purchases.

1. **Physiological Needs** – Basic survival needs such as food, water, and shelter. Consumers prioritize spending on groceries, clothing, and housing before other items.
2. **Safety Needs** – Protection and security, including health, insurance, and stable living conditions. Products like home security systems, healthcare services, and insurance policies meet these needs.
3. **Love and Belonging Needs** – Social connections, friendship, family, and acceptance. Consumers may buy communication devices, social apps, or gifts to strengthen relationships.
4. **Esteem Needs** – Status, recognition, and self-respect. Purchases like luxury goods, branded clothing, or career-enhancing tools reflect this level.
5. **Self-Actualization Needs** – Personal growth, education, and achieving potential. Consumers invest in learning, travel, hobbies, or experiences that fulfill personal goals.

By linking products and services to these needs, businesses can better target marketing strategies, influence purchasing decisions, and provide relevant customer experience.

Rational and Emotional Buying. Consumers make purchasing decisions based on different motives, which can be rational or emotional. Understanding these motives helps businesses tailor marketing, product features, and customer service effectively.

Rational Buying Motives: Decisions based on logic, facts, or practical considerations. Consumers evaluate products or services for their usefulness, value, quality, or efficiency. Rational motives are usually conscious, measurable, and easy to justify.

Examples:

- Buying a washing machine because it is energy-efficient and durable
- Choosing a car with high safety ratings
- Purchasing bulk groceries to save money
- Selecting a smartphone with the best battery life and features

Emotional Buying Motives: Decisions based on feelings, desires, or psychological satisfaction rather than practicality. Consumers are influenced by how a product makes them feel or how it reflects their identity. Emotional motives are often subconscious and tied to status, happiness, comfort, or personal identity.

Examples:

- Buying luxury clothing to feel stylish and confident
- Purchasing a gift to express love or appreciation
- Choosing a vacation package for relaxation or adventure
- Buying a trendy gadget to feel “up-to-date” or part of a social group

Influences of Income on Consumer Purchases. Income significantly affects what, how, and when consumers make purchases. Individuals with higher incomes have more disposable money, allowing them to buy luxury goods, invest in experiences, or choose premium brands. Conversely, those with lower incomes tend to prioritize essential items and seek value or cost-saving options.

Income also influences spending patterns, such as the frequency of purchases, brand selection, and willingness to pay for quality or convenience. Understanding the impact of income helps businesses target products appropriately, create pricing strategies, and design promotions that match the financial capacity of their customers.

Advertising Influences Purchases. Advertising influences consumer purchases by informing, persuading, and reminding people about products or services. It raises awareness of new or existing items, highlights benefits, and differentiates brands from competitors. Through persuasive techniques, such as appealing to emotions, showcasing lifestyles, or offering promotions, advertising can create desire and motivate consumers to take action.

Repeated exposure builds brand recognition and trust, making consumers more likely to choose advertised products over alternatives. Advertising also shapes perceptions of quality, status, and value, directly affecting buying decisions and encouraging repeat purchases.

AIDA Concept and Consumer Behaviour. The AIDA model is a marketing framework that explains the stages a consumer goes through when deciding to make a purchase. It helps businesses design advertising and sales strategies that guide consumers from awareness to action.

1. **Attention:** Capture the consumer's awareness of a product or service. This could be through eye-catching ads, social media posts, or promotions. Without attention, a consumer cannot begin the buying process.
2. **Interest:** Engage the consumer by highlighting features, benefits, or unique qualities that make the product appealing. This encourages them to learn more.
3. **Desire:** Create a strong emotional or practical need for the product, making the consumer want it. Marketing may show how the product improves life, solves a problem, or satisfies a want.
4. **Action:** Motivate the consumer to make a purchase, sign up, or take another desired step. This could include calls-to-action, discounts, or easy purchase options.

Relationship to Consumer Behaviour. The AIDA model mirrors the natural decision-making process of consumers. It addresses both rational motives (e.g., product benefits) and emotional motives (e.g., desire, status) while guiding them from awareness to purchase. Understanding AIDA helps businesses influence buying behaviour effectively through targeted marketing and quality customer service.

Customer Service. Maintaining high standards of personal health, grooming, and cleanliness is essential for delivering quality customer service. A professional appearance creates a positive first impression, builds trust, and conveys respect for customers and the workplace. Good hygiene and grooming demonstrate attention to detail, reliability, and self-respect, which directly affect how customers perceive the service or product being offered.

Employees who present themselves well are more confident, approachable, and effective in communication, enhancing overall customer satisfaction. In addition, proper personal health practices reduce the risk of spreading illness, ensuring a safe and comfortable environment for

both staff and customers. High standards in these areas reinforce professionalism and contribute to the overall reputation and success of a business.

Workplace Relationships. Effective customer service and workplace success depend on how well employees interact with customers, coworkers, supervisors, and suppliers. Each group requires specific communication and behaviour strategies.

Customers: Treat customers with respect, politeness, and patience. Listen actively to understand their needs and concerns. Communicate clearly and provide accurate information. Handle complaints professionally, seeking solutions that satisfy both the customer and the business.

- *Example: Greeting every customer warmly and addressing their questions without rushing.*

Coworkers: Foster teamwork, cooperation, and reliability. Share information and support colleagues when needed. Communicate respectfully and resolve conflicts calmly.

- *Example: Collaborating on a sales floor to restock products efficiently without argument.*

Supervisors: Follow instructions and meet deadlines. Ask questions when clarification is needed and accept feedback professionally. Demonstrate initiative and responsibility.

- *Example: Reporting a customer complaint to a supervisor promptly and suggesting possible solutions.*

Suppliers: Maintain professional and courteous communication. Build strong, reliable relationships to ensure timely delivery and quality products. Negotiate fairly and honor agreements.

- *Example: Placing orders accurately and confirming delivery schedules politely.*

Strong relationships with all workplace participants improve teamwork, efficiency, and customer satisfaction. Professional interaction demonstrates reliability, builds trust, and enhances the reputation of both the employee and the business.

Differences Between Sales Clerk/Service Provider and a Salesperson. While both roles involve assisting customers, their responsibilities, focus, and objectives differ in a retail or service environment.

Sales Clerk / Service Provider: Primarily focused on assisting customers and providing information rather than actively persuading them to make a purchase.

- Greet customers and answer questions about products or services
- Provide guidance on product use, features, or availability
- Handle transactions at the cash register (sales receipts, returns, exchanges)
- Maintain store appearance and restock shelves
- Follow store policies and procedures

Salesperson: Focused on actively promoting and selling products or services, often aiming to meet sales targets.

- Persuade and influence customers to purchase products or services

- Highlight product benefits and features to meet customer needs
- Upsell or cross-sell additional products
- Build relationships with customers to encourage repeat business
- Stay informed about competitors and market trends

A sales clerk ensures customers have a positive shopping experience by being helpful and knowledgeable, while a salesperson focuses on actively generating sales by influencing purchasing decisions. Both roles are essential for quality customer service and business success.

How Sales Clerks Obtain Product Knowledge. Sales clerks gain product knowledge through a combination of training, experience, and research to effectively assist customers and provide accurate information. This allows sales clerks to assist customers effectively, answer questions accurately, and provide quality service, which builds trust and encourages repeat business.

1. **Formal Training:**
 - Employers often provide training sessions, workshops, or manuals that cover product features, uses, and benefits.
 - Training may include company policies, pricing, warranties, and promotions.
2. **On-the-Job Experience:**
 - Handling products daily allows clerks to learn firsthand about quality, functionality, and customer preferences.
 - Observing experienced coworkers or supervisors provides practical insights.
3. **Manufacturer or Supplier Information:**
 - Clerks may consult product guides, websites, or supplier-provided materials to understand specifications and proper usage.
4. **Customer Feedback:**
 - Listening to customer questions, complaints, and suggestions helps clerks understand common issues and benefits.
5. **Continuous Learning:**
 - Keeping up with new products, trends, and technologies ensures clerks provide up-to-date and accurate information.

Quality Customer Service. Providing quality customer service requires professionalism, accuracy, and empathy in all interactions.

Preparing Sales Receipts/Bills

- Ensure accuracy in pricing, taxes, discounts, and totals.
- Process payments efficiently and securely, whether by cash, debit, or credit.
- Provide a clear and organized receipt for the customer.
- Maintain a friendly and polite demeanor during the transaction.

Dealing with Various Customer Types

- Adapt communication style to meet individual needs, whether the customer is friendly, indecisive, impatient, or demanding.
- Practice active listening to understand each customer's concerns or preferences.
- Remain professional and calm in all interactions, even with difficult customers.

Handling Customer Complaints and Returns

- Listen carefully and acknowledge the customer's concerns without interrupting.
- Remain polite, calm, and empathetic, showing a willingness to resolve the issue.
- Follow store policies to process returns, exchanges, or refunds efficiently.
- Offer alternatives or solutions when possible to maintain satisfaction.

Use of Proper Approach in Customer Service. A proper approach in customer service ensures that customers feel welcomed, respected, and supported throughout their shopping experience. It involves three key components: greeting, service, and merchandise handling.

Greeting

- Make first contact friendly and professional.
- Smile, make eye contact, and use polite language.
- Acknowledge each customer promptly to create a positive first impression.

Service

- Offer assistance proactively without being intrusive.
- Listen carefully to understand customer needs and provide accurate information.
- Adapt communication style to the customer's personality and situation.

Merchandise Handling

- Present products neatly and professionally.
- Demonstrate items if needed, highlighting key features and benefits.
- Ensure that merchandise is clean, organized, and accessible.

Importance of Upkeep and Maintenance of a Store. Upkeep and maintenance of a store are essential for creating a positive shopping environment, ensuring safety, and promoting efficient operations. A clean, organized, and well-maintained store makes a strong first impression, encouraging customers to browse and purchase products. Proper maintenance reduces hazards, protects merchandise, and prolongs the life of equipment and displays.

It ensures that products are readily available for customers, preventing frustration and lost sales. Well-organized shelves also improve product visibility, make shopping easier, and highlight promotions effectively. Regularly checking inventory and restocking items demonstrates professionalism, supports smooth operations, and enhances customer satisfaction, contributing to repeat business and a positive store reputation.

Quality Customer Service Skills as a Cashier. A cashier plays a crucial role in customer experience, often being the last point of contact during a purchase. Providing quality customer service as a cashier involves accuracy, efficiency, professionalism, and friendly interaction.

Key Skills and Practices**1. Accuracy and Attention to Detail**

- Ensure prices, discounts, and taxes are correctly applied.
- Accurately handle cash, debit, and credit transactions.

- Verify totals before completing a sale.
- 2. **Professional and Friendly Interaction**
 - Greet customers warmly and thank them for their purchase.
 - Maintain a polite and patient demeanor, even with difficult customers.
 - Communicate clearly when providing change, receipts, or explanations.
- 3. **Cash Handling and Financial Responsibility**
 - Manage cash floats carefully and reconcile cash at the end of shifts.
 - Prepare store deposits accurately according to store policies.
 - Follow procedures to prevent theft, errors, or loss.
- 4. **Efficiency and Time Management**
 - Process transactions quickly without sacrificing accuracy.
 - Handle multiple customers during busy periods professionally.
- 5. **Problem-Solving and Complaint Handling**
 - Address minor issues, returns, or discrepancies calmly.
 - Escalate complex issues to supervisors when necessary.

Required Assignment

/100 Marks

Flexible Submission Options: Written report, Slide presentation, Video presentation, Visual infographic, or Digital portfolio.

Students will demonstrate their understanding of the following areas:

Target Market Analysis (30 marks)

- Define target market
- Identify buyers, users, influencers
- Identify demographics and psychographics
- Identify target market for a product or service

Profile Baseline Consumer Behaviours (30 marks)

- Identify Needs vs. wants
- Explain Maslow's hierarchy with example
- Provide examples of buying motives (rational and emotional)
- Advertising influence and AIDA model

Identify the Importance of Customer Service Skills relative to the following: (30 marks)

- Professional appearance
- Customer interactions
- Complaint handling
- Retail procedures
- Cashier or service skills

Reflection (10 marks)

- Personal buying habits, Service strengths and areas for growth, Real-world applications

MAM1910: MAM PROJECT A

Description: Students develop project design and management skills to extend and enhance competencies and skills in other CTS courses through contexts that are personally relevant. Students will analyze target markets and retail merchandising strategies for three different products and/or services within a Canadian and Alberta context.

Target market helps businesses focus their marketing efforts effectively. Rather than trying to sell to everyone, companies identify specific consumers most likely to buy products or services.

Products and Services: These may include:

- Physical products (e.g., athletic shoes, smartphones, reusable water bottles)
- Services (e.g., car detailing, dog walking, tutoring)
- Digital products or services (e.g., streaming subscriptions, apps)

Retail Merchandising Strategies:

Store Layout: Placement of products in high-traffic areas, End-cap displays, Eye-level shelving

Visual Appeal: Colour schemes, Lighting, Clean and organized displays

Signage & Promotion: Sale signs, Feature signs explaining benefits, Limited time offers

Pricing Strategies: Competitive pricing, Bundle deals, Discounts or loyalty programs

Online Merchandising: Product photos, Clear descriptions, Reviews and ratings

Required Assignment**/100 Marks**

Students will complete a summative project analyzing **three** products and/or services. The project must demonstrate understanding of target markets and retail merchandising strategies.

For each of the **THREE** products and/or services, include:

1. Product or Service Description
2. Identification of Target Market (Demographic, Geographic, Psychographic, Behavioural)
3. Explanation of Target Market Choice
4. Retail Merchandising Strategies Identified
5. Analysis: Why These Strategies Fit the Target Market

Three products and/or services: 30 marks per x 3: 90 marks

Project organization and clarity of ideas: 10 marks

Total 100 marks

Flexible Submission Options: Choose from the following formats: Written report, Slide presentation (Google Slides / PowerPoint), Visual infographic, Video presentation, Digital marketing mock-up (website, social media campaign), or Oral presentation with visual support

MAM2010: MANAGING FOR QUALITY

Description: Students demonstrate basic managerial skills, by assuming roles and responsibilities of management in order to coordinate available resources and achieve quality results. Students will explore how customers, employees, teams, managers, and leaders all contribute to quality outcomes.

What Is Quality? Quality refers to the degree to which a product, service, or process meets or exceeds customer expectations.

- Quality is defined by the customer
- Quality is measured and monitored
- Quality is a continuous improvement process

Quality Assurance (QA): Planned processes to ensure consistent quality

Quality Control (QC): Inspection-based techniques to identify defects

Continuous Improvement: Ongoing efforts to improve products, services, or processes

Common Quality Management Systems (QMS). A Quality Management System (QMS) is a structured framework that organizations use to consistently meet customer expectations, improve efficiency, and reduce errors. A QMS helps ensure that quality is not accidental but is planned, monitored, and continuously improved.

Total Quality Management (TQM) is a management approach where everyone in the organization is responsible for quality, not just managers or inspectors. Includes: Focus on customer satisfaction, Continuous improvement, Employee involvement at all levels, Prevention of problems rather than correction, encourages teamwork and communication, empowers employees to suggest improvements, and builds a culture of shared responsibility.

ISO 9001 (International Organization for Standardization) is an internationally recognized quality management standard that sets requirements for how organizations manage processes and document quality practices. Includes: Standardized procedures, clear documentation, regular audits and reviews, focus on meeting customer and regulatory requirements, ensures consistency in products or services, reduces mistakes, builds customer trust and credibility.

Lean Management focuses on eliminating waste and improving efficiency while maintaining or improving quality. Includes: Waiting time, Overproduction, Excess inventory, Unnecessary motion, thus Streamlined processes, Continuous improvement (Kaizen) and Employee involvement in problem-solving

Role of the Customer in Managing for Quality. The customer plays a central role in managing for quality because quality is ultimately defined by their expectations, needs, and satisfaction. Customers provide feedback through surveys, reviews, complaints, or direct communication, which helps organizations identify strengths and areas for improvement. Their preferences and demands guide product or service design, operational processes, and service delivery standards.

By listening to and responding to customers, organizations can make informed decisions, implement changes, and continuously improve quality. Engaging customers in this way ensures that the organization's output meets or exceeds expectations and drives long-term success.

Role of Front-Line Employees. Play a critical role in managing quality because they are directly involved in delivering products or services to customers. They are often the first to notice defects, inefficiencies, or customer concerns, making them a key source of feedback for quality improvement.

Front-line employees implement established procedures, follow quality standards, and ensure that tasks are performed correctly and consistently. They also contribute ideas for process improvements, participate in problem-solving, and support team initiatives. By taking ownership of their work and maintaining high standards, employees help organizations meet customer expectations, reduce errors, and achieve continuous quality improvement.

Role of Groups and Teams. This can be used effectively by leveraging their combined skills, knowledge, and perspectives to achieve common objectives and maintain high-quality outcomes. Strategies include:

- **Clear Goals and Roles:** Defining the team's purpose, objectives, and individual responsibilities ensures that everyone understands their contribution and reduces confusion or overlap.
- **Effective Communication:** Encouraging open, respectful, and timely communication allows members to share ideas, provide feedback, and solve problems collaboratively.
- **Collaboration and Cooperation:** Promoting teamwork and mutual support helps members combine strengths, address weaknesses, and achieve tasks efficiently.
- **Decision-Making Processes:** Using structured approaches such as consensus, majority vote, or guided decisions ensures that choices are informed and supported by the team.
- **Monitoring and Accountability:** Tracking progress, reviewing performance, and providing constructive feedback keeps the team focused and maintains quality standards.
- **Conflict Resolution:** Addressing disagreements quickly and fairly ensures that tensions do not disrupt workflow or quality outcomes.

Decision-making processes when working in teams involve a structured approach that allows a group of individuals to reach a consensus or select the best course of action while leveraging diverse perspectives. In teams, decisions typically follow several key steps:

- **Identifying the problem or objective:** The team clearly defines the issue that requires a decision.
- **Gathering and analyzing information:** Members contribute relevant data, insights, and experiences to understand the situation fully.
- **Generating alternatives:** The team brainstorms multiple possible solutions or strategies.
- **Evaluating options:** Each alternative is assessed based on feasibility, risks, costs, and alignment with quality and organizational goals.
- **Reaching a decision:** The team may use consensus, majority vote, or leader-guided decisions to select the best option.
- **Implementing the decision:** Responsibilities are assigned, timelines established, and resources allocated.

- **Monitoring and reviewing outcomes:** The team evaluates the results of the decision and identifies opportunities for improvement.

Effective team decision-making promotes collaboration, leverages the strengths of all members, encourages ownership of outcomes, and ensures that decisions support high-quality results while minimizing errors and misunderstandings.

Quality is measured using a combination of quantitative and qualitative methods to ensure that products, services, and processes meet established standards and customer expectations.

- **Customer Feedback:** Surveys, reviews, complaints, and satisfaction ratings provide direct insights into how well quality meets customer needs.
- **Performance Metrics and Key Performance Indicators (KPIs):** Metrics such as defect rates, error rates, on-time delivery, and production efficiency quantify quality levels.
- **Compliance with Standards:** Adherence to internal procedures, industry regulations, or quality certifications (e.g., ISO 9001) ensures consistent quality.
- **Benchmarking:** Comparing organizational performance to industry best practices or competitors helps identify gaps and improvement opportunities.
- **Continuous Monitoring and Audits:** Regular inspections, process audits, and quality checks detect issues early and maintain consistency.
- **Employee and Team Assessments:** Observing staff performance, teamwork, and adherence to procedures contributes to understanding process quality.

By combining these measures, organizations can identify strengths and weaknesses, implement improvements, and maintain high-quality outcomes that achieve organizational goals.

Forecasting and Planning at Management Levels

Level	Focus	Time Frame	Example
Strategic	Long-term direction	3–5+ years	Corporate mission
Tactical	Department plans	1–3 years	Staffing plans
Operational	Daily activities	Short-term	Daily schedules

Managers play a central role in managing for quality by setting expectations, guiding employees, monitoring performance, and continuously improving organizational processes. Quality does not occur by chance; it is the result of deliberate managerial planning, leadership, and oversight.

Establishing Quality Standards and Expectations. Managers define what quality means for the organization. Clear standards provide employees with a consistent understanding of what is expected and reduce errors and confusion. Responsibilities include:

- Setting quality goals and performance standards
- Aligning quality expectations with customer needs
- Ensuring policies and procedures reflect quality objectives

Planning for Quality. Managers plan how quality will be achieved. Effective planning prevents problems rather than reacting to them after they occur. This includes:

- Allocating resources (time, staff, budget)
- Selecting quality management systems (e.g., TQM, Lean)
- Developing procedures and workflows that support quality outcomes

Organizing Resources and People. Managers organize tasks, teams, and structures to support quality. Well-organized systems reduce inefficiencies and ensure accountability. This includes:

- Assigning roles based on skill and expertise
- Creating effective teams
- Designing reporting structures and workflows

Leading and Motivating Employees. Managers influence quality through leadership and motivation. Motivated employees are more engaged and committed to maintaining high standards. Actions include:

- Modeling quality-focused behaviour
- Encouraging employee involvement and feedback
- Recognizing and rewarding quality performance

Monitoring Performance. Managers monitor quality to ensure standards are met. Monitoring allows managers to identify issues early and make data-informed decisions. This involves:

- Reviewing performance data and quality metrics
- Using technology to track outcomes
- Conducting audits, reviews, and evaluations

Problem-Solving and Improvement. Managers lead improvement efforts when quality issues arise. Continuous improvement strengthens processes and prevents recurring problems. Includes:

- Identifying root causes of problems
- Involving teams in solution development
- Implementing corrective actions

Supporting Teamwork. Managers ensure teams work effectively toward quality goals. Strong teamwork leads to better problem-solving and more consistent quality results. Includes:

- Facilitating communication
- Supporting collaborative decision-making
- Resolving conflicts promptly and fairly

Technology plays a critical role in managing quality by allowing organizations to collect, analyze, store, and share information accurately and efficiently. Effective monitoring helps managers make informed decisions, identify problems early, and improve overall quality.

- Technology allows organizations to gather large amounts of data quickly and accurately.
- Organizations use digital tools to monitor employees, team, and departmental performance.
- Customer Relationship Management (CRM) Systems store and analyze customer interactions and feedback.
- Technology helps monitor how work flows through an organization.

Conflict Resolution. Conflict is a normal part of organizations. When handled effectively, conflict can improve communication, strengthen teamwork, and lead to better decisions. Managers play a critical role in resolving conflicts that protect quality, morale, and productivity.

Recognize Conflict Early. Effective managers do not ignore conflict. Addressing conflict early prevents it from escalating and negatively affecting quality and workplace relationships.

- Watching for changes in behaviour or performance
- Listening to employee concerns
- Identifying tension between individuals or teams

Remain Neutral and Professional. Managers must approach conflict without bias. Neutrality builds trust and encourages honest communication.

- Avoid taking sides
- Focus on facts, not emotions
- Treat all parties with respect

Open Communication. Managers create a safe environment where staff can express concerns. Many conflicts are caused by misunderstandings. Clear communication resolves issues.

- Allow each person to speak without interruption
- Use active listening techniques
- Ask clarifying questions

Root Cause of the Conflict. Effective managers look beyond surface issues. Solving the root cause prevents the conflict from recurring. Common root causes include:

- Poor communication
- Unclear roles or expectations
- Workload imbalance, differences in values or work styles

Solution Orientated. Managers guide employees toward problem-solving rather than fault-finding. A solution-focused approach maintains professionalism and supports quality outcomes. Approaches include:

- Brainstorming solutions together
- Encouraging compromise when appropriate
- Aligning solutions with organizational goals and quality standards

Conflict Resolution Strategies. Managers select strategies based on the situation. No single approach works in all situations; flexibility is essential.

- Collaboration: Finding a win-win solution
- Compromise: Each side gives up something
- Accommodation: One party yield when the issue is minor
- Avoidance: Used temporarily if emotions are high
- Authority-based decisions: Used when immediate action is required

Clear Expectations and Agreements. After resolution, managers clarify expectations. Clear expectations reduce future misunderstandings and reinforce accountability. Actions include:

- Documenting agreements

- Reinforcing policies or procedures
- Setting follow-up expectations

Follow Up and Monitor. Effective managers check that the resolution is working. Monitoring ensures that conflict resolution supports long-term quality and team effectiveness.

- Observe workplace interactions
- Ask for feedback
- Adjust solutions if necessary

Positive and Respectful Culture. Long-term conflict prevention is part of quality management. A positive culture reduces conflict and supports continuous improvement.

Application in Group Environments. Using Quality Systems in Teams:

- Set team quality standards
- Use checklists and timelines
- Review outcomes together

Evaluating Current Management Systems. Evaluation criteria:

- Effectiveness
- Efficiency
- Employee satisfaction
- Customer outcomes

Management planning and **team planning** are related but operate at different levels within an organization and serve different purposes in achieving quality and organizational goals.

Management Planning:

- Conducted by managers and leaders at higher levels.
- Focuses on strategic and tactical objectives, long-term goals, and resource allocation.
- Involves forecasting, setting priorities, developing policies, and coordinating across departments.
- Ensures that the organization as a whole moves toward its mission and quality standards.
- Management planning is top-down and long-term, providing direction for the organization.

Team Planning:

- Conducted by individual teams or workgroups, often guided by a manager.
- Focuses on specific tasks, projects, or operational objectives.
- Involves assigning roles, setting deadlines, coordinating daily activities, and solving immediate problems.
- Ensures that the team's work is organized and aligned with broader management plans.
- Team planning is bottom-up and short-term, translating strategic goals into actionable steps.

Directing and **facilitating** are two different approaches managers use to guide teams, each with a distinct impact on quality and employee engagement.

- **Directing** involves giving clear instructions, making decisions for the team, and closely supervising tasks. It is often task-focused and ensures that work is completed according to specific standards and timelines. Directing is effective when precision, consistency, or compliance with procedures is critical, but it may limit creativity and employee initiative.
- **Facilitating**, on the other hand, focuses on supporting and guiding employees rather than controlling their actions. Managers provide resources, remove obstacles, encourage collaboration, and empower employees to make decisions. Facilitating promotes problem-solving, innovation, and ownership of work, which can enhance engagement and continuous improvement.

Organizing for Efficiency. People working toward a common objective can be organized for efficiency by clearly defining roles, responsibilities, and workflows to ensure that everyone knows what is expected and how their work contributes to the overall goal. Tasks should be divided based on skills, expertise, and capacity, so that work is assigned to those best equipped to complete it effectively. Establishing clear communication channels and reporting structures helps prevent duplication of effort and reduces errors. Teams should also have coordinated schedules, timelines, and resources, allowing tasks to be completed in the most logical sequence.

Additionally, setting performance standards, monitoring progress, and providing feedback ensures that the group remains aligned and productive. When people are organized in this way, they can collaborate smoothly, solve problems efficiently, and achieve high-quality results with minimal wasted effort.

Organizational Charts. An organizational chart is a visual diagram that shows the structure of an organization, including reporting relationships and the hierarchy of roles. By clearly showing the chain of command, organizational charts help ensure that quality responsibilities are assigned, monitored, and maintained.

- Helps employees understand who reports to whom and how teams are structured.
- Clarifies roles and responsibilities, reducing confusion and overlap.
- Supports efficient communication and decision-making.

Centralized vs Decentralized. Effective organizations often use a balance of both approaches.

Centralized Control: Decision-making is concentrated at the top levels of management.

- Advantages: Consistent decisions, easier implementation of policies, strong oversight.
- Disadvantages: Slower response to local issues, may reduce employee initiative.

Decentralized Control: Decision-making is distributed to lower levels of management or teams.

- Advantages: Faster responses, encourage innovation and empowerment, enhance engagement.
- Disadvantages: Potential inconsistency requires skilled employees.

Importance for Quality:

- Centralized control ensures standardized quality across the organization.

- Decentralized control allows teams to quickly address quality issues and implement improvements on the front line.

Power, Authority, Responsibility, Accountability, and Delegation

- **Power:** The ability to influence others to take action. Can be based on expertise, position, or personal traits.
- **Authority:** The legitimate right to make decisions and direct others. Granted by the organization through formal roles.
- **Responsibility:** The duty to complete assigned tasks or duties. Employees are responsible for performing work to expected standards.
- **Accountability:** The obligation to answer for outcomes of decisions and tasks. Goes hand-in-hand with responsibility; individuals are held accountable for results.
- **Delegation:** The process of assigning tasks and authority to others. Effective delegation ensures that work is done efficiently and develops employee skills.

Importance for Quality:

- Clear understanding of authority ensures decisions are made effectively and ethically.
- Responsibility and accountability promote high-quality work because employees know they are answerable for outcomes.
- Delegation allows managers to distribute work appropriately, ensuring tasks are completed correctly and on time, while also building a skilled and motivated workforce.

Ethical Issues of Monitoring Employees. Ethical issues related to monitoring and control of employees arise when organizations balance the need for quality, productivity, and accountability with respect for employee rights and dignity. Managers must consider privacy, transparency, and fairness when using monitoring tools such as performance tracking software, surveillance, or data collection systems.

Ethical concerns occur if employees are monitored without clear communication, if data is used punitively rather than for improvement, or if monitoring becomes excessive and creates stress or mistrust. To manage these issues responsibly, managers should clearly explain what is being monitored and why, ensure data is used fairly and securely, comply with legal standards, and focus on supporting employee performance rather than controlling behaviour.

Planning for Quality. Planning is a fundamental management role because it provides clear direction and ensures that quality is intentional rather than accidental. Through effective planning, managers establish clear objectives that define what quality looks like, develop a mission statement that communicates the organization's purpose and commitment to quality, and set realistic, measurable goals that guide employee effort and decision-making.

Planning also determines how objectives will be met by identifying strategies, allocating resources, setting timelines, and assigning responsibilities. When planning is done well, it aligns daily activities with long-term quality expectations, reduces uncertainty, and creates a structured pathway for continuous improvement and consistent performance.

Contingency Planning is vital because it prepares an organization to respond effectively to unexpected events or emergencies, minimizing disruptions and maintaining quality, productivity, and safety. By identifying potential risks such as equipment failure, supply chain disruptions, natural disasters, or sudden staff shortages, managers can develop alternative strategies, allocate resources, and establish clear procedures to handle crises.

This proactive approach ensures that objectives can still be met, customer expectations are maintained, and employees have guidance during uncertain situations. Without contingency planning, organizations are more vulnerable to delays, errors, and reduced quality, making it a critical component of effective management and risk mitigation.

Organizing as a basic management role is crucial for maintaining and improving quality because it ensures that resources, tasks, and people are structured effectively to achieve organizational objectives. Through organizing, managers assign responsibilities, define roles, establish reporting relationships, and design workflows that support efficiency and accountability. A well-organized structure prevents confusion, reduces errors, and ensures that employees understand their tasks and how their work contributes to overall quality standards.

Organizing also involves coordinating teams and resources so that processes run smoothly, deadlines are met, and customer expectations are consistently satisfied. By creating a clear, efficient, and well-managed environment, organizing enables organizations to maintain high-quality outcomes and supports continuous improvement efforts.

Leadership as a basic management role is essential for ensuring quality because it shapes the culture, motivation, and performance of the organization. Effective leaders guide employees toward achieving organizational objectives, inspire commitment to quality standards, and model behaviors that reflect excellence and accountability.

Leadership influences how teams communicate, collaborate, and solve problems, which directly affects the consistency and reliability of products or services. By providing vision, direction, and support, leaders create an environment where employees understand the importance of quality, are empowered to make improvements, and are motivated to take ownership of their work.

Leadership Styles. Leadership styles describe the different ways leaders guide, influence, and support others in achieving organizational goals and maintaining quality.

- **Autocratic** leadership involves making decisions independently and giving clear instructions; it can be effective in urgent situations but may reduce employee engagement.
- **Democratic (participative)** leadership encourages employee input and shared decision-making, which often improves motivation, teamwork, and quality outcomes.
- **Laissez-faire** leadership provides minimal direction and allows employees significant autonomy; this can be effective with highly skilled and self-motivated teams but may lead to inconsistency if guidance is lacking.
- **Transformational** leadership focuses on inspiring and motivating employees through vision, encouragement, and innovation, often leading to high commitment and continuous improvement.

- **Servant leadership** emphasizes supporting and empowering employees, prioritizing their development and well-being, which helps build trust and long-term quality performance.

Controlling leadership focuses on closely supervising employees, enforcing rules, and correcting performance to ensure tasks are completed according to established standards. This approach can be effective for maintaining consistency, meeting deadlines, and managing risk, especially in highly regulated or high-risk environments; however, excessive control can reduce employee motivation, creativity, and ownership of quality outcomes.

Empowering leadership emphasizes trust, autonomy, and shared decision-making by giving employees the authority and resources to take responsibility for their work. Empowering leaders encourage initiative, problem-solving, and continuous improvement, which often leads to higher engagement and stronger long-term quality results.

Power and authority are related but distinct concepts in leadership. **Power** is the ability of a leader to influence or persuade others to take action, whether through expertise, charisma, rewards, or coercion. It does not require formal position or title and can exist informally within an organization.

Authority is the legitimate right to make decisions and direct others, granted by the organization through a formal position or role. While authority gives a leader the official capacity to enforce rules and assign tasks, power determines how effectively they can motivate and influence people beyond formal directives.

The relationship to leadership lies in the fact that effective leaders use both authority and power: authority ensures clarity and organizational structure, while power builds trust, inspires commitment, and encourages employees to actively contribute to organizational goals.

Motivation Factors. Individual motivation is influenced by a combination of personal, job-related, and organizational factors that determine how engaged and committed an employee is to achieving quality and organizational goals.

- **Individual Differences:** Personal attitudes, values, needs, and goals shape motivation. For example, an employee who values recognition may be motivated by praise, while another who seeks career growth may respond better to development opportunities.
- **Job Characteristics:** The nature of the work itself affects motivation. Factors such as task significance, variety, autonomy, skill utilization, and feedback contribute to how meaningful and engaging a job feels, which influences effort and quality of work.
- **Organizational Policies and Practices:** Company rules, reward systems, and work culture impact motivation. Intrinsic rewards (e.g., recognition, sense of accomplishment) and extrinsic rewards (e.g., pay, bonuses) both play a role, as do fair policies, supportive management, and opportunities for advancement.

Leaders Influence Others. Effective leaders influence others to act by combining vision, communication, motivation, and example to align individual efforts with organizational goals.

- They share their vision clearly, helping employees understand the purpose and benefits of their work, which inspires commitment.
- They motivate individuals by recognizing achievements, providing encouragement, and aligning tasks with personal aspirations and strengths.
- Effective leaders also apply intuition and anticipate change, enabling them to guide teams through challenges and adapt strategies proactively.
- Foster collaboration by involving employees in decision-making and problem-solving, they model desired behaviours, demonstrating integrity, competence, and accountability.

Groups in Organizations. Organizations typically have formal and informal groups, each serving different purposes and influencing quality and productivity in unique ways.

Formal Groups: These are officially established by the organization to achieve specific objectives. Examples include departments, project teams, or committees. They have defined roles, responsibilities, and reporting structures. Formal groups are task-focused and structured to ensure organizational goals are met efficiently.

Informal Groups: This form naturally based on personal relationships, shared interests, or social connections among employees. Examples include lunch groups, peer support networks, or hobby clubs. Informal groups can influence morale, communication, and workplace culture positively or negatively.

Group Development and Processes: Effective group performance can be enhanced by:

- Establishing clear goals and roles to ensure accountability and purpose.
- Promoting open communication so members share ideas, feedback, and concerns freely.
- Providing support and resources to help the group achieve objectives.
- Fostering trust and collaboration through team building and recognition of contributions.
- Monitoring progress and providing feedback to guide improvement and maintain focus.

Communication is a fundamental management role because it ensures that information flows effectively between managers, employees, teams, and other stakeholders, which directly impacts quality outcomes. Effective communication allows managers to clearly convey expectations, goals, procedures, and feedback, ensuring that everyone understands their responsibilities and how their work contributes to organizational objectives. It also enables employees to share ideas, report issues, and suggest improvements, fostering collaboration and continuous improvement.

The relationship between communication, action, and quality results is direct: clear and timely communication guides employee actions, reduces misunderstandings and errors, and ensures that processes are followed correctly, which leads to consistent, high-quality results.

Conflict and Stress in the workplace often arise from a combination of organizational, interpersonal, and individual factors.

- **Poor Communication:** Misunderstandings, unclear instructions, or lack of feedback can create confusion and tension among employees and teams.

- **Role Ambiguity or Workload Issues:** Unclear responsibilities, overlapping duties, or excessive workloads can lead to frustration and conflict over tasks.
- **Differences in Values or Work Styles:** Diverse attitudes, beliefs, or approaches to work can create disagreements and stress when individuals clash.
- **Resource Constraints:** Limited time, budget, or materials can cause competition among employees and pressure to meet goals.
- **Organizational Change:** Restructuring, new management, or policy changes can create uncertainty and stress as employees adapt.
- **Interpersonal Conflicts:** Personality clashes, poor teamwork, or unresolved past disputes can escalate tensions and affect performance.

Required Assignment**/100 Marks**

Flexible Submission Options: Choose from the following formats: Written report, Slide presentation (Google Slides / PowerPoint), Visual infographic, Video presentation, Digital marketing mock-up (website, social media campaign), or Oral presentation with visual support

Final Summative Assessment:

Demonstrate understanding of managing quality by analyzing or applying quality management systems and leadership strategies in a real-world organization.

Organization Overview (35 marks)

- Research and describe **one** local, national or international organization
- Identify target market customers and services/products for organization

Quality Management Systems (35 marks)

- Identify quality systems/strategies used for selected organization
- Include a management or organizational flow chart for organization
- Explain how quality is measured within organization

Roles and Leadership (30 marks)

- Analyze roles of managers, employees, and teams for selected organization
- Include organizational goals and key policies
- Provide overview of leadership style and motivation strategies used by organization

Total: 100 Marks

MAM2030: VISUAL MERCHANDISING

Description: Students identify different types of visual merchandising and describe how to construct attention-getting displays and evaluate visual merchandising. Visual merchandising is the strategic presentation of merchandise to maximize sales, enhance customer experience, and reinforce a store's brand image.

Understanding Visual Merchandising. Merchandising is the strategic and intentional presentation of merchandise, store layouts, displays, lighting, signage, colour, and props to attract customers, communicate a store's brand, and encourage purchasing. Its primary purpose is to influence customer behaviour by making products appealing, easy to find, and visually engaging while creating a positive shopping experience.

Examples of Visual Merchandising**1. Window Displays**

- Mannequins dressed in seasonal clothing (e.g., winter jackets and boots in November)
- A themed display for Canada Day using red-and-white merchandise and signage

2. Interior Displays

- End-cap displays in grocery stores promoting sale items
- Folded clothing arranged by colour and size on tables
- Electronics displayed in locked glass cases with clear pricing and product features

3. Seasonal Displays

- Back-to-school displays featuring backpacks, notebooks, and lunch kits
- Holiday displays with coordinated décor, lighting, and gift suggestions
- Clearance displays highlighting discounted items at the end of a season

4. Point-of-Purchase Displays

- Small displays near checkout counters with snacks, accessories, or impulse-buy items

5. Store Layout and Signage

- Clear aisle signage directing customers to departments
- Feature tables placed near store entrances to draw attention to new products

Displays Influence the Customer. Displays play a significant role in shaping how customers think, feel, and behave while shopping. Effective visual merchandising influences purchasing decisions by guiding movement, creating interest, and reinforcing the store's overall image.

1. **Routing Customer Traffic:** Displays are used to direct how customers move through a store. Feature tables, floor layouts, and focal-point displays encourage customers to follow a specific path, increasing exposure to a wider range of products and extending the time spent in the store.
2. **Catching Attention:** Colour, lighting, height variation, and motion immediately attract the customer's eye. Eye-catching window and interior displays draw customers toward featured merchandise and encourage them to stop, look, and engage.

3. **Expanding and Communicating a Theme:** Visual presentations tell a story through coordinated colours, props, signage, and merchandise. A strong theme helps customers quickly understand a promotion, season, or lifestyle concept and makes the shopping experience more memorable.
4. **Creating a Pleasant Environment:** Well-organized, visually balanced displays create a welcoming and comfortable atmosphere. Customers are more likely to browse and return to a store that feels clean, attractive, and easy to navigate.
5. **Quick Product Identification:** Clear signage, logical grouping, and uncluttered displays help customers find products efficiently. When customers can quickly identify what they are looking for, frustration is reduced and satisfaction increases.
6. **Enticing Customers to Enter the Store:** Exterior window displays act as the store's first impression. An appealing window presentation can motivate customers to enter the store, even if they have not planned to shop.
7. **Reinforcing the Store Image and Brand:** Consistent use of colours, materials, and display styles strengthens brand identity. Customers begin to associate certain visual elements with the store's quality, price range, and target market.
8. **Supporting Sales Presentations:** Displays highlight key features, benefits, and uses of products, making it easier for sales staff to explain items and for customers to make informed purchasing decisions.

Types of Visual Merchandising Presentations. Presentations can be grouped into interior, exterior, and seasonal displays. Each type serves a specific purpose in attracting customers, promoting merchandise, and supporting sales.

Interior Visual Merchandising Presentations: Are located inside the store and are designed to organize merchandise, guide customer movement, and encourage purchasing

Open Interior Displays: Allow customers to freely touch, handle, and examine merchandise.

Examples include:

- Gondola displays: Long shelving units used in grocery and retail stores
- Wall shelving: Products displayed by category or brand
- Clothing racks: Garments arranged by size, colour, or style
- Platforms or ledges: Feature areas for new or promotional items

Closed Interior Displays: Protect merchandise and are often used for valuable or fragile items.

Examples include:

- Glass showcases: Jewelry or electronics displays
- Shadow boxes: Enclosed displays highlighting a single product or theme
- Architectural or built-up displays: Permanent or semi-permanent structures designed into the store layout

Exterior Visual Merchandising Presentations: Are located outside the store and are used to attract attention and encourage customers to enter.

- **Closed Window Displays:** The window is fully enclosed and does not allow a view into the store interior. *Example:* A fashion store window featuring mannequins, props, and signage that block the view inside.
- **Semi-Closed Window Displays:** Partially enclosed windows allow limited visibility into the store. *Example:* A display with mannequins and signage that still allows customers to see store lighting and interior movement.
- **Open Window Displays:** Provide a clear view directly into the store. *Example:* A shoe store with no backdrop, allowing customers to see active interior displays and shoppers inside.

Seasonal Visual Merchandising Presentations: Are time-based displays designed to reflect changes in seasons, holidays, or sales cycles.

- **Pre-Season Displays:** Introduce upcoming products before the season begins. *Example:* Winter coats and boots displayed in early fall.
- **Runner Displays:** Used throughout the main selling season to maintain interest and promote best-selling items. *Example:* Summer clothing displays maintained throughout July and August.
- **Clearance Displays:** Promote discounted merchandise at the end of a season. *Example:* A clearance rack with signage highlighting reduced prices on last season's inventory.

Coordinating Visual Presentations. Interior presentations can be coordinated with exterior presentations by ensuring consistency in theme, colour, merchandise selection, and overall design so that the customer experiences a seamless transition from outside the store to inside. The window display should introduce the key products, colours, or promotion, while interior displays expand on the same message through matching signage, layouts, and feature areas.

When customers enter the store, they should be able to easily locate the items they saw in the window, creating continuity and reducing confusion. This coordination strengthens brand identity, improves customer flow, and increases the likelihood of purchase by reinforcing visual cues and expectations established at the storefront.

Events and Themes. Ideas are generated by considering the purpose of the display and the event or theme being promoted, while also responding to customer interests and retail trends. Common sources of ideas include seasonal calendars (such as holidays, back-to-school, or seasonal changes), store promotions and sales events, and community or cultural celebrations.

Retailers also draw inspiration from current fashion, lifestyle, and colour trends, social media, advertising, and competitor displays. Additional ideas come from brand guidelines, available merchandise, and the target customer's age, lifestyle, and needs. By combining these influences, retailers develop creative visual presentations that are timely, relevant, and appealing to a wide variety of events and themes.

Elements of Design in Visual Merchandising. Are the basic visual components used to create effective merchandising displays. When applied thoughtfully, these elements help attract attention, organize merchandise, and communicate a clear message to the customer.

Line: Guide the customer's eye and create movement within a display.

- **Vertical lines:** Create a sense of height, strength, and formality (e.g., tall shelving or vertical signage).
- **Horizontal lines:** Suggest stability, calmness, and rest (e.g., tables or stacked merchandise).
- **Curved lines:** Add softness, flow, and a relaxed feeling (e.g., circular racks).
- **Diagonal lines:** Create energy, excitement, and motion (e.g., angled shelving or props).

Shape: Help define the structure and organization of a display.

- **Geometric shapes:** Squares, rectangles, and triangles create a clean, organized, and structured look.
- **Organic shapes:** Free-form and natural shapes create a relaxed and casual feel.
- **Positive space:** The areas occupied by merchandise and props.
- **Negative space:** Empty space around objects that prevents clutter and highlights key items.

Colour: Strongly influences mood, emotion, and customer behaviour.

- **Colour terminology:**
 - *Hue* (the actual colour)
 - *Value* (lightness or darkness)
 - *Intensity* (brightness or dullness)
- **Colour schemes:** Monochromatic, complementary, analogous.
- **Colour moods:**
 - Warm colours create energy and excitement.
 - Cool colours create calm and relaxation.
 - Neutral colours create balance and sophistication.

Background: Supports the merchandise and helps it stand out. An effective background keeps the focus on the product rather than distracting the customer.

- Should be simple and uncluttered, and contrast with the product
- May include walls, fabric, panels, or window backdrops

Three-Dimensional Space: Refers to the use of height, width, and depth in a display. This element helps make displays dynamic and engaging.

- Vertical space draws attention upward
- Depth creates layers and visual interest
- Proper spacing prevents overcrowding

Weight, Size, and Texture: These elements affect balance and visual interest.

- **Visual weight:** Heavier-looking items draw more attention and must be balanced.
- **Size:** Larger items act as focal points; smaller items support them.
- **Texture:** Adds depth and contrast (e.g., smooth, rough, soft, or shiny materials).

Principles of Design in Visual Merchandising. Explain how the elements of design are arranged and organized to create effective merchandising displays. When applied correctly, these principles help displays look balanced, attractive, and easy for customers to understand.

Pattern: Create visual interest and guide the customer's eye through a display. Patterns include:

- Interface: Merchandise arranged in a straight line where items meet evenly
- Stairstep: Items arranged in increasing or decreasing height
- Gradation: Gradual change in size, colour, or height
- Pyramid: Large items at the bottom, smaller items at the top
- Zigzag: Items arranged in an angular, energetic pattern
- Repetition: Repeating similar items or colours
- Radiation: Items arranged outward from a central focal point

Balance: Refers to the visual stability of a display.

- Formal balance: Symmetrical arrangement on both sides of a central point; creates order and structure.
- Informal balance: Asymmetrical arrangement using different objects of equal visual weight; creates a more relaxed and dynamic look.

Harmony and Contrast: Effective displays balance harmony with contrast to avoid being boring or chaotic.

- Harmony: Ensures all elements work together and feel visually connected.
- Contrast: Uses differences in colour, size, shape, or texture to create interest and highlight important items.

Rhythm: Creates movement and flow, leading the customer's eye naturally through the display.

- Achieved through repetition, progression, or alternating elements
- Encourages customers to look at the entire display rather than just one area

Proportion: Refers to the size relationship between objects in a display.

- Items should be sized appropriately in relation to each other and the display space
- Poor proportion can make displays look cluttered or unbalanced

Emphasis: Creates a focal point that immediately draws attention.

- Achieved using colour, lighting, size, or placement
- Helps highlight featured or promotional merchandise

Unity: Means all elements in the display work together as a cohesive whole.

- Achieved through consistent theme, colour, style, and purpose
- Creates a clear message and professional appearance

Collection of Ideas for a Calendar Year. This collection outlines monthly visual merchandising themes that can be used by retail businesses to attract customers, reflect seasonal changes, and support sales throughout the year.

January – New Beginnings / Clearance
February – Valentine’s Day / Appreciation
March – Spring Preview
April – Earth Day / Sustainability
May – Mother’s Day / Spring Lifestyle
June – Graduation / Summer Kickoff
July – Canada Day / Summer Fun
August – Back-to-School
September – Fall Transition
October – Halloween / Autumn Events
November – Black Friday / Pre-Holiday
December – Winter Holidays

Basic Guidelines for Visual Presentations. When creating visual merchandising presentations, retailers follow basic guidelines to ensure displays are clear, attractive, and effective in influencing customer behaviour.

- **Use the “Keep It Simple” Concept:** Displays should be uncluttered and easy to understand at a glance. Too many products, colours, or props can confuse customers and reduce impact. A simple display highlights key merchandise and communicates the message quickly.
- **Keep the Customer’s Viewpoint in Mind:** Visual presentations should be designed from the customer’s perspective. Merchandise should be placed at eye level when possible, signage should be easy to read, and displays should be accessible to all customers, including those using mobility aids.
- **Use Lighting to Enhance the Display:** Proper lighting draws attention to featured products and creates mood. Spotlights, accent lighting, or natural light can be used to highlight focal points, improve visibility, and make merchandise appear more appealing.
- **Use Props to Enhance Merchandise and Theme:** Props should support the theme and complement the merchandise without overpowering it. Effective props help tell a story, provide context for product use, and increase visual interest while keeping the focus on the products being sold.

Planning a Visual Presentation. Effective merchandising requires careful planning. The following steps ensure that displays are purposeful, appealing, and support store objectives:

Identify the Objective: Determine the purpose of the display. Examples include:

- Promoting a new product
- Highlighting a seasonal theme
- Driving sales of a particular category
- Enhancing the store image

Select the Theme, Merchandise, and Location

- **Theme:** Choose a concept that aligns with the objective and target audience (e.g., summer fun, back-to-school, holiday celebration).
- **Merchandise:** Decide which products will be featured based on inventory, season, and sales goals.

- **Location:** Select a high-traffic area that maximizes visibility and impact, such as window displays, endcaps, or store entrances.

Cost of Constructing the Presentation

- Estimate costs for materials, props, signage, lighting, and any labor.
- Ensure the display stays within the allocated budget while maintaining quality and effectiveness.

Supplies and Materials Needed

- Gather props, display fixtures, signage, and any decorative items.
- Ensure all materials are clean, functional, and safe for use in the display.

Prepare Display Area, Merchandise, and Props

- Clear the display space of old merchandise or clutter.
- Organize and condition merchandise for presentation (fold, hang, or group items).
- Prepare props for installation, ensuring they complement the theme.

Construct Visual Presentation

- Arrange merchandise according to design principles (balance, emphasis, rhythm, proportion).
- Use elements such as colour, lines, shapes, and textures to create an engaging layout.
- Incorporate props and signage to enhance the theme and guide the customer's eye.

Maintain the Display

- Regularly check the display for dust, damage, or disorganization.
- Replace sold items with new stock to keep the display full and appealing.
- Refresh or update the display to maintain seasonal or promotional relevance.

Evaluating the Effectiveness of a Visual Presentation. After a display is constructed, it is essential to evaluate its effectiveness to ensure it meets objectives, attracts customers, and supports sales. Evaluation involves examining several key factors:

1. **Location:** Assess whether the display is in a high-traffic area where customers will notice it. Consider visibility both outside and inside the store. Determine if the placement encourages customer flow through the store.
2. **Design:** Evaluate whether the display is visually appealing and organized. Check for balance, proper use of colour, lines, shapes, and textures. Ensure the focal point is clear and the design is easy for customers to understand.
3. **Theme:** Determine whether the display effectively communicates its intended theme or message. Check if merchandise, props, and signage support the concept consistently. Ensure the theme is relevant to the season, event, or promotion.
4. **Impact and Appeal:** Observe customer engagement: Are customers stopping, looking, or interacting with the display? Monitor sales of featured merchandise before and after the display is installed. Assess whether the display creates a positive impression and reinforces the store's image.

Required Assignment**/100 Marks**

Students must select a current local, regional or national business that uses interior and/or exterior visual merchandising.

Part A: Description of Effective Visual Merchandising Presentations (35 Marks)

Students will explain how the chosen business currently uses effective visual merchandising presentations. Students will:

- Identify **two** types of visual merchandising presentations used by the business (interior, exterior, seasonal, or promotional)
- Describe how elements of design (colour, line, shape, space, texture) are used
- Explain how the displays influence customer behaviour (attention, movement, purchasing decisions)
- Include visuals such as photographs, sketches, screenshots, or diagrams where possible

Part B: Calendar-Year Collection of Visual Merchandising Ideas (30 Marks)

Create a 12-month visual merchandising plan for the same business. Include:

- Develop one themed visual merchandising idea for each month of the calendar year
- Describe the theme, featured merchandise, and target customer

Part C: Evaluation of Visual Merchandising Forms (35 Marks)

Evaluate various forms of visual merchandising used by the business. Include:

- Evaluate **two** different visual merchandising forms (e.g., window displays, interior displays, seasonal promotions, point-of-purchase displays)
- Assess effectiveness based on: Location, Design, Theme, Impact and appeal

Flexible Submission Options: Students may choose one or a combination of the following formats: Written report, Digital slideshow, Visual portfolio with photos and captions, Video presentation or walkthrough, Physical model or mock display (with written explanation)

MAM2040: RETAIL OPERATIONS

Description: Students identify and demonstrate retail operations that are typically performed off the selling floor and/or away from customers. Students will explore store policies, buying and receiving merchandise, pricing, inventory control, and financial documentation. Emphasis is placed on practical skills, workplace readiness, and real-world retail decision making.

Retail Store Policies: Retail store policies are written rules and procedures that guide how a business operates. These policies help ensure consistency, fairness, legal compliance, and positive customer and employee experiences. While policies vary by store type (grocery, clothing, electronics, online retail), most retailers establish policies in the following key areas.

Sales and Service Policies: Sales and service policies outline how customers are treated during and after a purchase. Protects both the customer and the business while promoting trust and satisfaction. Examples across retail stores:

- Return and exchange timelines (e.g., 14-day return with receipt)
- Refund methods (original payment or store credit)
- Warranty coverage for products
- Customer service expectations and complaint handling

Credit and Collection Policies: These policies explain how credit is offered and how payments are collected. Reduces financial risk and ensures responsible lending in accordance with Canadian consumer protection laws. Examples across retail stores:

- Store credit cards or financing plans
- Buy-now-pay-later options
- Limits on credit amounts
- Late payment fees and interest charges

Store Security Policies: Security policies are designed to prevent theft, loss, and fraud. Protects inventory, cash, employees, and customers while maintaining a safe environment. Examples across retail stores:

- Use of surveillance cameras
- Procedures for handling suspected shoplifting
- Employee theft prevention measures
- Cash-handling rules and till counts

Human Resources (HR) Policies: HR policies govern employee conduct, rights, and responsibilities. Ensures fair treatment of employees and compliance with employment legislation. Examples across retail stores:

- Hiring and termination procedures
- Workplace behaviour and dress codes
- Scheduling, breaks, and overtime
- Health and safety policies (aligned with Alberta OHS standards)

Recordkeeping Policies: Recordkeeping policies outline how business records are created, stored, and protected. Supports financial accuracy, legal compliance, and effective business decision-making. Examples across retail stores:

- Sales and inventory records
- Payroll and employee files
- Invoices and purchase orders
- Tax records (e.g., GST documentation)

Duties of a Buyer. A buyer is responsible for selecting, purchasing, and managing merchandise that meets customer demand while supporting the financial goals of a retail business. Their duties include researching market trends, analyzing sales data, and forecasting demand to determine what products to carry and in what quantities. Buyers evaluate and select suppliers, negotiate prices and delivery terms, and place orders using purchase orders or requisition forms.

They also monitor inventory levels, ensure products arrive on time and in acceptable condition, and address issues such as shortages, damage, or substitutions. Overall, the buyer plays a key role in balancing product availability, quality, and profitability to ensure the store remains competitive and well stocked.

Classification of Goods. Goods in retail are classified to help businesses organize merchandise, plan buying decisions, and meet customer needs. Goods are classified as follows:

Classification by Type of Goods

- Convenience goods: Items purchased frequently with little planning (e.g., milk, newspapers).
- Impulse goods: Items bought spontaneously without prior intent (e.g., candy, magazines).
- Shopping goods: Products customers compare for price, quality, and style before buying (e.g., clothing, electronics).
- Specialty goods: Unique or high-end items for which customers are willing to make a special effort (e.g., designer brands).
- Staple goods: Basic necessities purchased regularly (e.g., bread, toiletries).

Classification by Brand Name

- National brands: Well-known brands sold by many retailers (e.g., Nike, Apple).
- Private brands: Store-owned brands exclusive to a retailer (e.g., President's Choice).
- Generic brands: Low-cost, unbranded or minimally branded products.

Classification by Use

- Consumer goods: Items purchased for personal or household use.
- Business goods: Items used by businesses to operate or produce other goods.

Classification by Durability

- Durable goods: Long-lasting products (e.g., furniture, appliances).
- Non-durable goods: Products consumed quickly (e.g., food, paper products).

Product and Fashion Life Cycle. The product and fashion life cycle describes the stages a product goes through from introduction to removal from the market. Both typically include four stages: introduction, growth, maturity, and decline. Fashion items usually move through this cycle much faster than basic products, as styles and trends change quickly, making timing and inventory management especially important for retailers.

Stages:

1. **Introduction:** In this stage, sales are low as the product is launched and awareness is built.
2. **Growth:** Demand increases, sales rise, and profits improve as the product gains acceptance.
3. **Maturity:** Is marked by peak sales, increased competition, and stable but slower growth, often requiring promotions to maintain market share.
4. **Decline:** Sales decrease due to changing consumer preferences, new products, or trends.

Buying Data and Sources. Buying data and sources are the information and references buyers use to make informed purchasing decisions for a retail business. Buying data includes sales history, inventory levels, customer demand, pricing trends, and seasonal patterns, which help buyers forecast demand and determine appropriate quantities.

Buying sources refer to where this information and merchandise come from, such as suppliers, manufacturers, wholesalers, trade shows, sales representatives, catalogues, and online vendor platforms. Buyers also consider supplier reputation, product quality, pricing, availability, and delivery reliability when evaluating sources. Together, buying data and sources allows buyers to select the right products at the right price and time to meet customer needs while controlling costs and inventory.

Purchase Orders and Requisition Forms. The purpose of purchase orders and requisition forms is to ensure that goods are ordered accurately, authorized properly, and documented clearly. A requisition form is used internally to request approval to purchase goods, confirming that the items are needed and within budget.

Once approved, a purchase order is sent to the supplier and serves as a formal, legally binding document that specifies the items ordered, quantities, prices, delivery terms, and payment conditions. Together, these forms help prevent ordering errors, control spending, provide a record for receiving and invoicing, and support accurate recordkeeping and accountability.

Shipping Terms. Define when ownership of goods transfers from the seller to the buyer and who is responsible for shipping costs and risk. These terms directly affect the buyer's costs, liability, and recordkeeping.

- **FOB (freight on board) Factory** means the buyer takes ownership of the goods at the seller's factory. The buyer is responsible for all shipping costs, insurance, and any loss or damage once the goods leave the factory. This can reduce the purchase price but increases the buyer's risk and responsibility for transportation.
- **FOB (freight on board) Destination** means the seller retains ownership and responsibility for the goods until they are delivered to the buyer's location. The seller

pays the shipping costs and assumes the risk of loss or damage during transit. This reduces risk and simplifies receiving but often results in a higher purchase price.

- **FOB (freight on board) Shipping Point** means ownership transfers to the buyer once the goods leave the seller's shipping location. The buyer pays freight costs and assumes risk during transit. This term requires the buyer to manage transportation issues and file claims if goods are damaged or lost, but it may offer lower overall pricing.

Receiving Merchandise. Procedures and methods used for receiving goods ensure that merchandise arrives accurately, safely, and in sellable condition. These procedures help prevent loss, ensure accuracy, and support effective inventory control.

- When a shipment arrives, staff first receive the goods by signing for the delivery and moving items to a designated receiving area.
- The shipment is then checked against the purchase order and packing slip to confirm quantities, product descriptions, and prices. Goods are inspected for damage, defects, or substitutions, and any discrepancies are documented and reported to the supplier.
- Once verified, merchandise is recorded in inventory systems and properly stored or stocked, either placed on the sales floor, organized as backup stock, or stored in a warehouse according to safety and space requirements.

Remedies and Actions. When problems occur with orders, buyers have several remedies and actions they can take to protect the retailer and ensure accurate inventory and payment.

- **Damage or breakage**, the buyer can document the condition of the goods upon receipt, refuse the damaged items if necessary, and file a damage claim with the supplier or carrier. The buyer may request a replacement, repair, or credit on the invoice.
- **Substitution or poor quality**, the buyer can reject the shipment or the incorrect items, notify the supplier of the discrepancy, and request the correct merchandise, a price adjustment, or a return authorization. In some cases, the buyer may negotiate a discount if the goods are still usable.
- **Overage or shortage**, the buyer compares the shipment to the purchase order and packing slip, then reports any discrepancies to the supplier. The buyer may return excess items, request missing items, or have the invoice adjusted to reflect the actual quantity received.
- **Lost or misplaced**, the buyer can track the shipment using shipping documentation, contact the supplier or carrier, and file a claim if necessary. The buyer may request a replacement shipment or a refund, depending on the shipping terms and responsibility for the loss.

Invoices and Payments. The process for handling invoices for payment of goods and services ensures that retailers pay accurately, on time, and in accordance with agreed terms.

1. **Receiving the Invoice:** When goods or services are delivered, the supplier sends an invoice detailing the items, quantities, prices, discounts, and total amount due.
2. **Verification:** The invoice is compared against the purchase order and receiving documents to confirm that the correct goods were delivered at the correct price. Any discrepancies, such as damaged goods or shortages, are resolved before payment.
3. **Recording:** Once verified, the invoice is recorded in the accounts payable system or purchase journal to track the retailer's financial obligations.

4. **Approval:** The invoice is reviewed and approved by authorized personnel to ensure the payment is valid and within budget.
5. **Payment:** Payment is made according to the agreed terms, which may include payment by cheque, electronic funds transfer, or cheque requisition. Discounts for early payment may be applied if available.
6. **Filing and Recordkeeping:** Paid invoices are filed for recordkeeping, auditing, and tax purposes. This process ensures financial accuracy, accountability, and proper documentation for the business.

Pricing, Markups, and Markdown. Markup is the difference between the cost of a product and its selling (retail) price, expressed either as a dollar amount or as a percentage. It represents the amount added to the cost to cover expenses and generate a profit. When calculated based on cost, the formula is:

$$\text{Markup (\%)} = \frac{\text{Retail Price} - \text{Cost Price}}{\text{Cost Price}} \times 100$$

This shows how much above the cost the item is sold for. For example, if an item costs \$50 and is sold for \$75, the markup is \$25, or 50% of the cost. Retailers use markup to set prices that ensure profitability while remaining competitive. Calculating markup based on the retail price is another method, which expresses the profit as a percentage of the final selling price, but the cost-based method is the most commonly used in retail operations.

Break Even Point. Is the level of sales at which a business covers all its costs, meaning total revenue equals total expenses, and there is neither profit nor loss. It helps retailers determine how much they need to sell to avoid losing money.

Formula:

$$\text{Break-even Point (units)} = \frac{\text{Fixed Costs}}{\text{Selling Price per Unit} - \text{Variable Cost per Unit}}$$

- **Fixed Costs:** Costs that do not change with sales volume (e.g., rent, salaries).
- **Variable Costs:** Costs that change with production or sales (e.g., cost of goods sold).
- **Selling Price per Unit:** The retail price of each item.

Example:

- Fixed Costs = \$2,000
- Variable Cost per Unit = \$20
- Selling Price per Unit = \$50

$$\text{Break-even Point} = \frac{2,000}{50 - 20} = \frac{2,000}{30} \approx 67 \text{ units}$$

The retailer must sell approximately 67 units to cover all costs. Selling more units generates profit; selling fewer results in a loss. The break-even point is a critical tool for pricing, inventory, and sales planning in retail operations.

Price Tag. The type of tag a retailer uses depends on the store size, product type, and sales method. Common types include:

- **Manual Price Tags:** Handwritten or pre-printed tags attached to products. Suitable for small stores or specialty items.
- **Barcoded Price Tags:** Include a barcode along with the price for use with scanners at checkout. Common in medium to large retail stores for efficiency and accuracy.
- **Electronic Price Tags (EPT):** Digital displays that can be updated remotely. Used in large or high-tech stores to quickly change prices or promotions.
- **Sticker Labels:** Adhesive tags that can be placed directly on products, suitable for clearance items or bulk goods.
- **Swing Tags:** Hanging tags attached with string or plastic fasteners, often used for clothing or accessories.

A price tag provides both the customer and the retailer with essential information about the product. This information ensures accuracy in pricing, supports inventory control, and makes it easier for staff and customers to identify and purchase products. Pertinent information includes:

- **Retail Price:** The selling price of the item that the customer pays.
- **Product Description:** Name, style, or brief description to identify the item.
- **SKU or Item Code:** A unique identifier used for inventory tracking.
- **Cost Code:** Internal code indicating the cost category or department for accounting and recordkeeping purposes.
- **Size, Colour, or Variant:** Relevant details for apparel, accessories, or items with multiple options.
- **Barcode or QR Code:** Enables scanning for sales, inventory management, and tracking.
- **Brand or Manufacturer:** Helps distinguish between national, private, or generic brands.
- **Promotional Information (Optional):** Discounts, sale price, or special offers.

Mark Downs. Goods are marked down when their selling price is reduced below the original retail price, usually to encourage sales, clear inventory, or respond to market conditions. Markdowns occur for several reasons:

- **Seasonal Clearance:** At the end of a season, unsold seasonal items (e.g., winter coats, holiday decorations) are reduced to make room for new stock.
- **Slow-Moving Inventory:** Products that are not selling as expected may be discounted to increase turnover.
- **Overstocked Items:** Excess inventory may be marked down to prevent storage costs or obsolescence.
- **Damage or Imperfections:** Slightly damaged or defective products are often discounted to recover some value.
- **Promotions and Sales Events:** Retailers may mark down goods during sales events, holidays, or special promotions to attract customers.

The buyer or manager determines the markdown amount based on cost, original price, and target profit. The new price is applied to the product and updated on tags or point-of-sale systems. Markdowns are recorded in inventory and sales reports to track the effect on revenue.

Pricing policies are strategies retailers use to set the selling price of goods in a way that achieves business objectives, attracts customers, and remains competitive. Different policies have distinct applications and effects:

- **Market Penetration Pricing:** Setting a low initial price to attract customers and gain market share quickly. *Effect:* Encourages high sales volume and customer loyalty but may result in lower short-term profit.
- **Price Skimming:** Setting a high initial price for new or unique products to maximize profit from early adopters. *Effect:* Generates high profit per unit but may limit the number of buyers initially.
- **Comparable or Competitive Pricing:** Pricing products in line with competitors' prices for similar items. *Effect:* Helps remain competitive, avoids price wars, and maintains perceived fairness in the market.
- **Flexible Pricing:** Using variable pricing strategies such as one-price (fixed) or negotiable pricing. *Effect:* Allows adaptation to different customers or market conditions but requires careful management to avoid confusion or perceived unfairness.
- **Relative Pricing:** Setting prices based on the desired image, perceived value, or target profit margin. *Effect:* Positions products according to brand strategy, influencing customer perception and purchase decisions.

Pricing policies directly affect sales volume, profitability, customer perception, and inventory turnover. Retailers select and apply policies based on product type, market demand, competition, and financial goals to achieve balanced and effective pricing strategies.

Inventory Control. Retailers use different methods of inventory control to track stock, prevent shortages or overstocking, and manage costs effectively. Each method helps retailers balance inventory availability, reduce costs, and improve efficiency. Common methods include:

- **Periodic Inventory:** Inventory is counted at regular intervals (e.g., weekly, monthly, or annually) to determine stock levels and calculate cost of goods sold. Suitable for small businesses with limited inventory.
- **Perpetual Inventory:** Inventory records are continuously updated as items are received, sold, or returned, often using computer systems or barcode scanning. This provides real-time stock levels and accurate financial data.
- **Just-in-Time (JIT) Inventory:** Stock is ordered and received only as needed to meet demand, minimizing storage costs and reducing excess inventory. This method requires reliable suppliers and careful demand forecasting.
- **ABC Analysis:** Inventory is categorized by value and importance (A = high-value, B = moderate-value, C = low-value), allowing retailers to focus control efforts on the most critical items.
- **Minimum-Maximum Stock Levels:** Establishes a minimum and maximum quantity for each item to maintain adequate supply while avoiding overstocking.

Stock turnover (also called inventory turnover) measures how quickly a retailer sells and replaces inventory over a specific period. It indicates the efficiency of inventory management and how well products are selling.

Formula:

$$\text{Stock Turnover} = \frac{\text{Cost of Goods Sold (COGS)}}{\text{Average Inventory}}$$

- **Cost of Goods Sold (COGS):** The total cost of products sold during the period.
- **Average Inventory:** The average value of inventory held during the same period, usually calculated as $(\text{Beginning Inventory} + \text{Ending Inventory}) \div 2$.

Example:

- COGS = \$30,000
- Average Inventory = \$10,000

$$\text{Stock Turnover} = \frac{30,000}{10,000} = 3$$

The inventory was sold and replaced three times during the period. High turnover indicates fast-moving products and effective inventory management. Low turnover may suggest overstocking, slow sales, or obsolete items. Stock turnover helps buyers plan orders, control inventory levels, and optimize profitability.

Stocking and Storage. When orders are received, buyers must consider how goods are stocked and stored to ensure efficiency, accessibility, and preservation of quality.

Sales Floor Stocking:

- Products should be displayed attractively and arranged logically for customer convenience.
- Fast-selling items should be easily accessible to encourage repeat purchases.
- Stock rotation (e.g., first-in, first-out) ensures older products are sold before newer stock, reducing waste.

Backup Stock Off the Selling Floor:

- Extra inventory should be stored nearby in an organized manner for quick replenishment of the sales floor.
- Items should be clearly labeled with product codes and quantities to minimize errors.
- Storage should maintain product integrity (e.g., fragile items secured, perishable goods refrigerated).

Warehouse Storage:

- Larger quantities or seasonal stock may be stored in a warehouse.
- Use space efficiently, with heavy or bulky items placed safely to prevent accidents.
- Proper recordkeeping and inventory systems are essential for tracking location and quantity of all items.

Buyers must balance availability, accessibility, and safety while minimizing loss, damage, or stockouts. Proper stocking and storage practices directly affect sales and profitability.

Required Assignment

/100 Marks

Students will demonstrate their understanding of retail operations through a flexible final project.

Flexible Submission Options: Students may choose one or a combination of the following formats: Written report, Digital slideshow, Visual portfolio with photos and captions, Video presentation or walkthrough, podcast.

Final Summative Assessment Components:

1. identify and report on a selected retailer's policies and practices **(20 marks)**
2. Explain the product and fashion life cycle **(15 marks)**
3. Analyze what remedies the buyer has or what actions can be taken for: *damage or breakage, substitution or poor quality, overage or shortage, lost or misplaced order* **(35 marks)**
4. Identify the different types of discounts available to retailers **(15 marks)**
5. Describe pricing strategies used by retailers **(15 marks)**

Total: 100 Marks

MAM2090: PROMOTION – PRINT ADVERTISING

Description: Students are introduced to communication channels, delivery strategies and advertising media that can be used to inform potential customers about products and services available in the marketplace. Students will explore the purpose of advertising, examine various target markets, learn planning and design techniques for print media, and analyze the effectiveness of advertising campaigns.

Introduction to Advertising. Advertising is a paid, non-personal form of communication used by businesses, organizations, or individuals to promote products, services, ideas, or causes to a specific audience. Its main purpose is to inform consumers about products or services, persuade them to make a purchase or take the desired action, remind them of a brand to encourage loyalty, and build a positive image or reputation for the company.

By delivering a clear and strategic message through various media such as print, broadcast, or digital platforms, advertising helps organizations reach large audiences effectively while supporting marketing goals and driving business growth.

Publicity and advertising are both tools used to communicate messages about products, services, or organizations, but they differ in several keyways. Advertising is paid and controlled, while publicity is unpaid and often controlled by external media.

- **Cost:** Advertising is paid for by the organization, whereas publicity is usually free and generated by media coverage or public interest.
- **Control:** In advertising, the company has full control over the message, design, and timing. In publicity, the organization has limited control because the media decides how the story is presented.
- **Purpose:** Advertising aims to promote and sell products or services, while publicity often seeks to inform, create awareness, or generate interest without direct payment.
- **Example:** A full-page magazine ad for a new smartphone is advertising; a news article highlighting the launch of that smartphone is publicity.

Criticisms/Controversy. Advertising often faces criticism and controversy for several reasons:

1. **Misleading or False Claims:** Ads may exaggerate benefits or make claims that are not entirely true.
2. **Targeting Vulnerable Audiences:** Children, elderly, or low-income groups may be unfairly influenced.
3. **Stereotyping and Social Impact:** Ads can reinforce gender, racial, or cultural stereotypes.
4. **Materialism and Overconsumption:** Encourages excessive spending or unrealistic lifestyles.

Laws in Canada. Advertising must comply with legal regulations to protect consumers:

- **Competition Act:** Prohibits false or misleading representations and deceptive marketing practices.
- **Canadian Code of Advertising Standards:** Ensures honesty, decency, and accuracy in advertising.

- **Privacy Laws:** Regulate the collection and use of consumer data for targeted advertising.
- **Industry-Specific Rules:** Certain sectors, such as alcohol or tobacco, have stricter advertising restrictions.

Ethics. Ethical advertising goes beyond legal compliance and focuses on social responsibility:

- **Truthfulness:** Avoiding deceptive or exaggerated claims.
- **Transparency:** Clearly distinguishing advertisements from editorial content.
- **Respect:** Avoiding content that is offensive or discriminatory.
- **Social Responsibility:** Promoting products and messages that consider the well-being of society and the environment.

While advertising is a powerful marketing tool, it is often scrutinized for misleading claims, ethical concerns, and social impact. Laws and ethical guidelines in Canada help ensure that advertising remains truthful, fair, and socially responsible.

Advertising Strategies. Different types of advertisements are tailored to specific target markets, whether they are individual consumers, businesses, or communities, ensuring the message reaches the audience most likely to respond positively.

Consumer Products: Goods purchased by individuals for personal use. *Examples:*

- **Smartphones:** Teenagers and young adults who value technology and social connectivity.
- **Clothing brands:** Fashion-conscious adults aged 18–35.
- **Snack foods:** Children and families seeking convenient, tasty options.

Consumer Services: Services purchased by individuals for personal use. *Examples:*

- **Gym memberships:** Adults aged 25–45 interested in health and fitness.
- **Streaming services (Netflix, Disney+):** Families and young adults seeking entertainment.
- **Hair salons or spas:** Adults looking for personal care and relaxation.

Business Products: Products purchased by organizations for use in operations, production, or resale. *Examples:*

- **Office printers and supplies:** Small to medium-sized businesses.
- **Industrial machinery:** Manufacturing companies needing equipment.
- **Commercial cleaning products:** Hotels, schools, and office buildings.

Business Services: Services purchased by organizations to support operations. *Examples:*

- **IT support services:** Small and medium enterprises requiring technology solutions.
- **Accounting and bookkeeping services:** Startups and established companies needing financial management.
- **Marketing and advertising agencies:** Businesses seeking promotional campaigns.

Advocacy (Institutional) Advertising: Promotes ideas, causes, or institutions rather than products. *Examples:*

- **Environmental campaigns (e.g., recycling initiatives):** Local communities and environmentally conscious individuals.
- **Public health campaigns (e.g., anti-smoking, vaccination drives):** General population or specific risk groups.
- **Charity fundraising ads:** Donors, volunteers, and socially responsible citizens.

Objectives of Advertising Campaigns. Marketers develop advertising campaigns with specific goals in mind. These objectives guide the message, design, and placement of the advertisement. Common objectives include:

1. **Increase Awareness:** Introduce a new product, service, or brand to the market. Example: A new smartphone launch ad highlighting its features.
2. **Inform Consumers:** Provide details about a product's features, uses, or benefits. Example: A brochure explaining a health insurance plan's coverage options.
3. **Persuade or Influence Buying Decisions:** Encourage customers to choose a specific product or service over competitors. Example: A car ad emphasizing fuel efficiency and reliability to persuade buyers.
4. **Remind Customers:** Maintain brand awareness and loyalty by keeping the product top-of-mind. Example: Seasonal Coca-Cola ads reminding consumers of the brand during holidays.
5. **Build Brand Image or Reputation:** Communicate values, mission, or social responsibility to enhance the company's image. Example: An ad showing a company's commitment to environmental sustainability.
6. **Encourage Trial or Usage:** Motivate potential customers to try a product or service, often through promotions. Example: Free sample campaigns for a new snack or beverage.
7. **Support Sales Promotions or Special Offers:** Drive immediate sales through discounts, coupons, or limited-time offers. Example: "Buy one, get one free" campaigns in retail stores.
8. **Promote Advocacy or Social Causes:** Raise awareness or influence public opinion about social issues. Example: Anti-smoking campaigns or fundraising ads for charities.

Advertising objectives can be grouped into informing, persuading, reminding, building reputation, and promoting action. Clear objectives ensure the advertisement is focused, effective, and reaches the intended audience.

Geographical Promotional Strategies. Geographical promotional strategies involve tailoring advertising campaigns based on the location or region of the target audience. Different strategies help businesses reach the right customers efficiently.

1. **Local Advertising:** Targets a specific community, town, or neighborhood.
 - *Examples:*
 - Flyers or posters promoting a local bakery.
 - Local radio ads for a nearby car dealership.
 - Social media ads targeting residents within a 10 km radius of a store.
2. **Regional Advertising:** Focuses on a province or larger area.

- *Examples:*
 - Magazine ads targeting residents in Alberta for a regional furniture store.
 - Billboard campaigns along highways in Western Canada for a regional chain of gyms.
- 3. **National Advertising:** Reaches customers across an entire country.
 - *Examples:*
 - Television commercials aired on national networks promoting a new soft drink.
 - National print ads in magazines and newspapers for a nationwide retail chain.
- 4. **International Advertising:** Targets consumers in multiple countries, often requiring cultural adaptation.
 - *Examples:*
 - Global campaigns by Coca-Cola or Nike using standardized branding with localized messaging.
 - Travel and tourism ads promoting international destinations to foreign markets.

Geographical promotional strategies allow marketers to focus their resources and tailor messages to local, regional, national, or international audiences, ensuring the advertisement is relevant and effective for the intended location.

Print Media: refers to physical publications used to communicate advertising messages.

Examples: Newspapers, Magazines, Brochures and flyers, Posters and billboards

Advantages:

- Tangible and can be kept for reference.
- Targeted distribution (local, regional, or niche audiences).
- Allows for detailed information and visuals.
- Can be cost-effective for small audiences or local campaigns.

Disadvantages:

- Declining readership due to digital media.
- Limited interactivity with the audience.
- Production and placement costs can be high for larger campaigns.
- Ads may be overlooked or ignored (especially in newspapers).

Broadcast Media: refers to audio-visual channels that transmit advertising messages to a large audience. *Examples:* Television, Radio

Advantages:

- Wide reach; can target millions of viewers or listeners.
- Engaging through sight, sound, and motion (TV) or voice (radio).
- Creates strong brand recognition and emotional appeal.
- Ideal for mass-market products or time-sensitive promotions.

Disadvantages:

- Expensive to produce and air, especially TV commercials.
- Short exposure time; viewers may miss the ad.
- Limited ability to provide detailed information.
- Less targeted unless using specific channels, programs, or timeslots.

Components of a print advertisement. A well-designed print advertisement combines borders, headline(s), illustrations/graphics, copy, and a logo to capture attention, communicate the message clearly, and create brand recognition. Each component plays a specific role in guiding the reader's attention and persuading them to act.

- **Borders:** The frame or outline around the ad that separates it from surrounding content. Helps focus attention on the advertisement and gives it structure. Example: A thick border around a flyer making it stand out on a bulletin board.
- **Headline(s):** The main text or phrase that captures the reader's attention. Grabs attention immediately and conveys the key message. Example: "Summer Sale – Up to 50% Off!"
- **Illustrations or Graphics:** Images, photographs, or drawings included in the ad. Attracts attention, supports the message, and helps the audience visualize the product. Example: A picture of a new smartphone showing its design and features.
- **Copy:** The written text that explains details about the product, service, or offer. Provides information, explains benefits, and persuades the reader to take action. Example: "Our new organic coffee is fair-trade certified and roasted locally for the freshest taste."
- **Logo (Signature):** The company's symbol, trademark, or name used consistently across all ads. Ensures brand recognition and builds trust with the audience. Example: The McDonald's golden arches at the bottom of a flyer.

Costs of Advertisements vs. Return on Investment (ROI). When planning advertisements, businesses must consider both the cost of creating and placing an ad and the return on investment (ROI) the financial or strategic benefit gained from the campaign.

Advertisement Costs

- **Creation Costs:** Expenses for designing the ad, including graphics, photography, copywriting, and layout.
- **Placement Costs:** Fees for publishing the ad in a chosen medium:
 - Print (newspapers, magazines, flyers)
 - Broadcast (TV, radio)
 - Digital (social media, websites)
- **Example:** A full-page magazine ad may cost several thousand dollars, whereas a local flyer may cost only a few hundred.

Measuring Return on Investment (ROI). ROI measures how much benefit the advertisement generates compared to its cost.

- Formula:

$$\text{ROI (\%)} = \frac{\text{Gain from Advertisement} - \text{Cost of Advertisement}}{\text{Cost of Advertisement}} \times 100$$

- Example:

- Cost of ad: \$2,000
- Sales generated: \$5,000
- $\text{ROI} = (5,000 - 2,000) / 2,000 \times 100 = 150\%$

Comparison Considerations:

- **High-Cost Ads:** TV commercials or full-page national magazine ads may reach large audiences but are expensive. The ROI must justify the cost.
- **Low-Cost Ads:** Flyers, local posters, or social media ads are cheaper but may have a smaller reach. ROI may be high if the target market is effectively reached.
- **Targeted Approach:** Ads that are highly targeted often generate better ROI because they reach the audience most likely to respond.

When planning advertisements, businesses must balance costs with expected returns. A successful ad campaign maximizes ROI by ensuring that the benefits, sales, awareness, or brand recognition, exceed the expenses of creating and placing the ad.

Steps in Planning a Print Advertisement

1. **Determine the Form of Print Media:** Decide the type of print medium that best suits your message and target audience. Considerations: Audience reach, cost, and placement location. *Examples: Flyer, poster, brochure, magazine ad, newspaper ad, or billboard.*
2. **State the Objective:** Clearly define the purpose of the advertisement. *Examples: Increase sales of a product, Promote a service, Build brand awareness, Announce an event or promotion*
3. **Define the Target Audience:** Identify the group of people most likely to respond positively to the ad. Factors to consider: Age, gender, income, lifestyle, location, interests. *Example: Teenagers for a new video game release, adults 25–40 for a fitness program.*
4. **Select the Buying Motive / Unique Selling Proposition (USP):** Determine what will persuade the audience to take action. USP: The feature or benefit that makes the product/service unique. *Example: “Our coffee is 100% organic and locally roasted” or “Save 30% this weekend only.”*
5. **Plan the Layout and Components:** Decide on the design and placement of ad elements: borders, headline, graphics, copy, and logo. Consider effective use of white space, font styles, and visual hierarchy to attract attention and convey the message clearly.

Planning a print advertisement involves a step-by-step process: choosing the medium, setting clear objectives, defining the audience, identifying what will motivate them to act, and designing the layout effectively. A well-planned ad ensures that the message reaches the right audience in a clear and persuasive way.

Effective Layout Arrangements

- **Borders:** Frame content.
- **White Space:** Prevent clutter, improve readability.
- **Fonts:** Different sizes and styles emphasize key points.
- **Placement of Components:** Visual hierarchy to guide reader's attention.

Required Assignment**/100 Marks**

Create print advertisements for **three** products/services targeting three distinct target markets.

Final Summative Assessment Components:

1. Identify **three** products/services and explain their target markets.
2. Describe objectives for each of the **three** advertisements.
3. Create or find a print advertisement for each product/service, above demonstrating:
 - *Effective layout*
 - *Use of borders, white space, and fonts*
 - *Clear headline and copy*
 - *Appropriate graphics/illustrations*
4. Share digital portfolio of the **three** products/services advertisements selected (30 marks each x3= 90 marks)
5. Submit reflection on design choices and strategy. (10 marks)

Flexible Submission Options: Physical poster/flyer presentation, Digital portfolio (PDF, PowerPoint, Canva), Video presentation explaining ads, Written report with scanned ads and analysis.

MAM2910: MAM PROJECT B & MAM2920: MAM PROJECT C

Description: Students develop project design and management skills to extend and enhance competencies and skills in other CTS courses through contexts that are personally relevant.

Students are introduced to advertising media that can be used to inform potential customers about products and services available in the marketplace.

Students identify different types of visual merchandising and describe how to construct attention-getting displays and evaluate visual merchandising

Required Assignment**/100 Marks****MAM2910: PROJECT B (100 marks)**

1. Provide **three** examples of products that illustrate a variety of target markets (20 marks)
2. Identify **two** examples of geographical promotional strategies for selected business. (30 marks)
3. Find **two** examples of various print and broadcast media that businesses are using. (30 marks)
4. Design and create **one** effective print advertisement that uses effective layout arrangements. (20 marks)

MAM2920: PROJECT C (100 marks)

1. Provide an overview of basic visual merchandising concepts. (20 marks)
2. Explain how displays/visual presentations can influence the customer and provide one example presentation. (30 marks)
3. Select **three** visual merchandising displays/images and identify why they are used by the business. (30 marks)
4. List **FIVE** visual merchandising or advertising ideas, including target markets, for local businesses. (20 marks)

Flexible Submission Options: Choose from the following formats: Written report, Slide presentation (Google Slides / PowerPoint), Visual infographic, Video presentation, Digital marketing mock-up (website, social media campaign), or Oral presentation with visual support

CTS Assessment Rubric

Knowledge & Understanding: Demonstrates understanding of concepts, terminology, and processes related to the module. Applies knowledge accurately in practical and theoretical tasks.

Skills & Application: Demonstrates technical skills and competencies required for the module. Applies skills effectively to complete tasks, projects, or problem-solving situations.

Communication & Professionalism: Communicates clearly (oral, written, or digital as appropriate). Demonstrates responsibility, organization, safety, and professional conduct in work.

Creativity & Initiative: Demonstrates innovation, problem-solving, and adaptability in approaching tasks. Shows initiative, independence, and perseverance in completing module outcomes.

1. Knowledge & Understanding

- Excellent (5): Demonstrates thorough and insightful understanding of concepts, terminology, and processes; consistently applies knowledge with accuracy and depth.
- Proficient (4): Demonstrates solid understanding of concepts and processes; applies knowledge accurately with minor errors.
- Acceptable (3): Demonstrates basic understanding of key concepts and processes; applies knowledge with occasional inaccuracies or gaps.
- Limited (1–2): Demonstrates minimal understanding of concepts and processes; frequent inaccuracies or lack of application.

2. Skills & Application

- Excellent (5): Consistently demonstrates strong technical skills; work is accurate, efficient, and exceeds module expectations.
- Proficient (4): Demonstrates competent technical skills; work is generally accurate and meets module expectations.
- Acceptable (3): Demonstrates developing technical skills; work is partially accurate and inconsistently meets expectations.
- Limited (1–2): Demonstrates limited technical skills; work is incomplete, inaccurate, or rarely meets expectations.

3. Communication & Professionalism

- Excellent (5): Consistently communicates clearly and effectively in multiple formats; demonstrates professionalism, organization, and responsibility at all times.

- Proficient (4): Communicates effectively in most situations; generally demonstrates professionalism and responsibility.
- Acceptable (3): Communicates ideas with some clarity; professionalism and responsibility are inconsistent.
- Limited (1–2): Communication is unclear or incomplete; demonstrates limited professionalism or responsibility.

4. Creativity & Initiative

- Excellent (5): Consistently demonstrates innovation, problem-solving, and independence; takes initiative to extend learning beyond expectations.
- Proficient (4): Demonstrates creativity and initiative; solves problems with some support and extends learning at times.
- Acceptable (3): Demonstrates some creativity and initiative; relies on support to solve problems and meet outcomes.
- Limited (1–2): Demonstrates little creativity or initiative; rarely attempts problem-solving independently.

Assessment Total:	/20 points x5	/100 marks
Knowledge & Understanding	_____	
Skills & Application	_____	
Communication & Professionalism	_____	
Creativity & Initiative	_____	

Each category may be tailored to the specific context of the CTS course. This rubric provides a balanced approach to assess students' skills and competencies in a comprehensive manner.

Comments: